

God's Truth

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The First Book of Moses

also called Genesis from the Latin

The 1st Chapter

In the beginning God created heaven and earth. The earth was void and empty, and darkness was upon the deep, and the spirit of God moved upon the water.

Then God said: let there be light: and there was light. And God saw the light that it was good: and divided the light from the darkness, and called the light day, and the darkness night: and so of the evening and morning was made the first day.

And God said: let there be a firmament between the waters, and let it divide the waters asunder. Then God made the firmament, and parted the waters which were under the firmament, from the waters that were above the firmament: And it was so. And God called the firmament Heaven. And so of the evening and morning was made the second day.

And God said: let the waters that are under heaven gather themselves unto one place, that the dry land may appear. And it came so to pass. And God called the dry land the earth, and the gathering together of waters called he the sea. And God saw that it was good.

And God said: let the earth bring forth herb and grass that sow seed, and fruitful trees, that bear fruit every one in his kind, having their seed in themselves upon the earth. And it came so to pass. And the earth brought forth herb and grass sowing seed every one in his kind, and trees bearing fruit, and having their seed in themselves, every one in his kind. And God saw that it was good, and then of the evening and morning was made the third day.

Then said God: let there be lights in the firmament of heaven, to divide the day from the night, that they may be unto signs, seasons, days and years. And let them be lights in the firmament of heaven, to shine upon the earth: And so it was. And

God made two great lights: A greater light to rule the day, and a less light to rule the night: and he made stars also. And God put them in the firmament of heaven to shine upon the earth, and to rule the day and the night: and to divide the light from darkness. And God saw that it was good: and so of the evening and morning was made the fourth day.

And God said: let the water bring forth creatures that move and have life, and fowls for to fly over the earth under the firmament of heaven. And God created great whales and all manner of creatures that live and move, which the waters brought forth in their kinds, and all manner of feathered fowls in their kinds. And God saw that it was good: and God blessed them saying: Grow and multiply and fill the waters of the seas, and let the fowls multiply upon the earth. And so of the evening and morning was made the fifth day.

And God said: let the earth bring forth living creatures in their kinds: cattle and worms and beasts of the earth in their kinds, and so it came to pass. And God made the beasts of the earth in their kinds, and cattle in their kinds, and all manner worms of the earth in their kinds: and God saw that it was good.

And God said: let us make man in our similitude and after our likeness: that he may have rule over the fish of the sea, and over the fowls of the air, and over cattle, and over all the earth, and over all worms that creep on the earth. And God created man after his likeness, after the likeness of God created he him: male and female created he them.

And God blessed them, and God said unto them: Grow and multiply and fill the earth and subdue it, and have dominion over the fishes of the sea, and over the fowls of the air, and over all the beasts that move on the earth.

And God said: see, I have given you all herbs that sow seed, which are on the earth, and all manner trees that have fruit in them and sow seed: to be meat for you and for all beasts of the earth, and unto all fowls of the air and unto all that creeps on the earth where in is life, that they may have all manner herbs and grass for to eat, and even so it was. And God beheld all that he had made, and lo they were exceeding good: and so of the evening and morning was made the sixth day.

The 2nd Chapter

Thus was heaven and earth finished with all their apparel, and in the seventh day God ended his work which he had made, and rested in the seventh day from all his works which he had made. And God blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it, for in it he rested from all his works which he had created and made.

These are the generations of heaven and earth when they were created, in the time when the Lord God created heaven and earth and all the shrubs of the field before they were in the earth. And all the herbs of the field before they sprang, for the Lord God had yet sent no rain upon the earth, neither was there yet any man to till the earth. But there arose a mist out of the ground, and watered all the face

of the earth: Then the Lord God shaped man, even of the mold of the earth, and breathed into his face the breath of life. So man was made a living soul.

The Lord God also planted a garden in Eden from the beginning, and there he set man whom he had formed. And the Lord God made to spring out of the earth, all manner trees beautiful to the sight and pleasant to eat, and the tree of life in the midst of the garden: and also the tree of knowledge of good and evil.

And there sprang a river out of Eden to water the garden, and there divided itself, and grew into four principal waters. The name of the one is Phison, he it is that compasses all the land of Hevila, where gold grows. And the gold of that country is precious, there is found Bedellion and a stone called Onyx. The name of the second river is Gihon, which compasses all the land of Inde. And the name of the third river is Hidekell, which runs on the east side of the Assyrians. And the fourth river is Euphrates.

And the Lord God took Adam, and put him in the garden of Eden, to dress it and to keep it. And the Lord God commanded Adam saying: Of all the trees of the garden see you eat: But of the tree of knowledge of good and bad see that you eat not: For even the same day you eat of it you shall die the death.

And the Lord God said: It is not good that man should be alone, I will make him an helper to bear him company. And after that the Lord God had made of the earth all manner beasts of the field, and all manner fowls of the air, he brought them unto Adam to see what he would call them. And as Adam called all manner living beasts, even so are their names. And Adam gave names unto all manner cattle, and unto the fowls of the air, and unto all manner beasts of the field. But there was no help found unto Adam to bear him company.

Then the Lord God cast a slumber on Adam, and he slept. And then he took out one of his ribs, and in stead thereof he filled up the place with flesh. And the Lord God made of the rib which he took out of Adam, a woman: and brought her unto Adam. Then said Adam: This is once bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh. This shall be called woman: because she was taken of the man. For this cause shall a man leave father and mother, and cleave unto his wife, and they shall be one flesh. And they were either of them naked, both Adam and his wife, and were not ashamed.

The 3rd Chapter

But the serpent was subtler than all the beasts of the field, which the Lord God had made: and said unto the woman: you, has God said in deed, you shall not eat of all manner trees in the garden? And the woman said unto the serpent, of the fruit of the trees in the garden we may eat, but of the fruit of the tree that is in the midst of the garden (said God) see that you eat not, and see that you touch it not, least you die. Then said the serpent unto the woman: tush you shall not die: but God does know that whensoever you should eat of it, your eyes should be opened,

and you should be as God, and know both good and evil. And the woman saw that it was a good tree to eat of, and lusty unto the eyes, and a pleasant tree for to give understanding. And took of the fruit of it and ate, and gave unto her husband also with her, and he ate. And the eyes of both of them were opened, that they understood how that they were naked. Then they sewed fig leaves together and made them aprons.

And they heard the voice of the Lord God as he walked in the garden in the cool of the day. And Adam hid himself and his wife also from the face of the Lord God, among the trees of the garden. And the Lord God called Adam, and said unto him: where are you? And he answered: your voice I heard in the garden, but I was afraid, because I was naked, and therefore hid myself. And he said: Who told you that you was naked? have you eaten of the tree, of which I bade you that you should not eat? And Adam answered: The woman which you gave to bear me company, she took me of the tree, and I ate. And the Lord God said unto the woman: Wherefore did you so? And the woman answered: The serpent deceived me and I ate.

And the Lord God said unto the serpent: because you have so done most cursed be you of all cattle and of all beasts of the field: upon your belly shall you go: and earth shall you eat all days of your life. Moreover I will put hatred between you and the woman, and between your seed and her seed. And that seed shall tread you on the head, and you shall tread it on the heel.

And unto the woman he said: I will surely increase your sorrow, and make you often with child, and with pain shall you be delivered: And your lusts shall pertain unto your husband, and he shall rule you.

And unto Adam he said: Forasmuch as you have obeyed the voice of your wife, and have eaten of the tree of which I commanded you, saying: See you eat not thereof: cursed be the earth for your sake. In sorrow shall you eat thereof all days of your life: And it shall bear thorns and thistles unto you. And you shall eat the herbs of the field. In the sweat of your face shall you eat bread, until you return unto the earth from what you was taken: for earth you are, and unto earth shall you return.

And Adam called his wife Heva, because she was the mother of all that lives. And the Lord God made Adam and his wife garments of skins, and put them on them. And the Lord God said: Lo, Adam is become as it were one of us, in knowledge of good and evil. But now least he stretch forth his hand and take also of the tree of life, and eat and live ever. And the Lord God cast him out of the garden of Eden, to till the earth from what he was taken. And he cast Adam out, and set at the entering of the garden Eden, Cherubim with a naked sword moving in and out, to keep the way to the tree of life.

The 4th Chapter

And Adam lay with Heva his wife, which conceived and bare Cain, and said: I have gotten a man of the Lord. And she proceeded forth, and bare his brother Abel: And Abel became a shepherd, and Cain became a plowman.

And it fortun'd in process of time, that Cain brought of the fruit of the earth, an offering unto the Lord. And Abel he brought also of the firstlings of his sheep, and of the fat of them. And the Lord looked unto Abel and to his offering, but unto Cain and unto his offering looked he not. And Cain was wroth exceedingly, and lowered. And the Lord said unto Cain: why are you angry, and why lowerest (lower yourself) you? Know you not if you do well you shall receive it? But and if you do evil, by and by your sin lies open in the door. Notwithstanding let it be subdued unto you, and see you rule it. And Cain talked with Abel his brother.

And as soon as they were in the fields, Cain fell upon Abel his brother, and slew him. And the Lord said unto Cain: where is Abel your brother? And he said: I cannot tell, am I my brothers keeper? And he said: What have you done? The voice of your brothers blood cried unto me out of the earth. And now cursed be you as pertaining to the earth, which opened her mouth to receive your brothers blood of your hand. For when you till the ground she shall from this time forth not give her power unto you. A vagabond and a *runagate (renegade; one who flees) shall you be upon the earth.

And Cain said unto the Lord: my sin is greater, than that it may be forgiven. Behold you cast me out this day from off the face of the earth, and from your sight must I hide myself, and I must be wandering and a vagabond upon the earth: Moreover whosoever finds me, will kill me. And the Lord said unto him: Not so, but whosoever slays Cain shall be punished sevenfold. And the Lord put a mark upon Cain that no man that found him should kill him. And Cain went out from the face of the Lord, and dwelt in the land Nod, on the east side of Eden.

And Cain lay with his wife, which conceived and bare Henoah. And he was building a city, and called the name of it after the name of his son, Henoah. And Henoah begat Irad. And Irad begat Mahuiahel. And Mahuiahel begat Mathusael. And Mathusael begat Lamech. And Lamech took him two wives: the one is called Ada, and the other Zilla: And Ada bare Jabal, of whom came they that dwell in tents and possess cattle. And his brothers name was Jubal, of him came all that exercise themselves on the harp and on the organs. And Zilla she also bare Tubalcain a worker in metal and a father of all that grave in brass and iron. And Tubalcains sister was called Naema.

Then said Lamech unto his wives Ada and Zilla: hear my voice you wives of Lamech and hearken unto my words, for I have slain a man and wounded myself, and have slain a young man, and got myself stripes: For Cain shall be avenged sevenfold: but Lamech seventy times sevenfold. Adam also lay with his wife yet

again, and she bare a son and called his name Seth. For God (said she) has given me another son for Abel whom Cain slew. And Seth begat a son, and called his name Enos. And in that time began men to call on the name of the Lord.

The 5th Chapter

This is the book of the generation of man. In the day when God created man and made him after the similitude of God. Male and female made he them, and called their names man, in the day when they were created. And when Adam was an hundred and thirty years old, he begat a son after his likeness and similitude: and called his name Seth. And the days of Adam after he begat Seth, were eight hundred years, and begat sons and daughters. And all the days of Adam which he lived, were nine hundred and thirty years, and then he died.

And Seth lived an hundred and five years, and begat Enos. And after he had begot Enos he lived eight hundred and seven years, and begat sons and daughters. And all the days of Seth were nine hundred and twelve years, and died. And Enos lived eighty (kjb=ninety) years, and begat Kenan. And Enos after he begat Kenan, lived eight hundred and fifteen years, and begat sons and daughters: and all the days of Enos were nine hundred and five years, and then he died. And Kenan lived seventy years, and begat Mahalaliel. And Kenan after he had begot Mahalaliel, lived eight hundred and forty years, and begat sons and daughters: and all the days of Kenan were nine hundred and ten years, and then he died. And Mahalaliel lived sixtyfive years, and begat Jared. And Mahalaliel after he had begot Jared lived eight hundred and thirty years, and begat sons and daughters: and all the days of Mahalaliel were eight hundred ninety and five years, and then he died.

And Jared lived an hundred and sixtytwo years, and begat Henoah: and Jared lived after he begat Henoah, eight hundred years, and begat sons and daughters. And all the days of Jared were nine hundred and sixtytwo years, and then he died. And Henoah lived sixtyfive years, and begat Mathusala. And Henoah walked with God after he had begot Mathusalah, three hundred years, and begat sons and daughters: And all the days of Henoah were three hundred and sixtyfive years, and then Henoah lived a godly life, and was no more seen, for God took him away.

And Mathusala lived an hundred and eightyseven years and begat Lamech: and Mathusala after he had begot Lamech, lived seven hundred and eighty two years, and begat sons and daughters. And all the days of Mathusala were nine hundred sixtynine years, and then he died.

And Lamech lived an hundred eightytwo years and begat a son, and called him Noe, saying: This same shall comfort us: as concerning our work and sorrow of our hands which we have about the earth that the Lord has cursed. And Lamech lived after he had beget Noe, five hundred, ninety and five years, and begat sons and daughters. And all the days of Lamech were seven hundred seventyseven years,

and then he died. And when Noe was five hundred years old, he begat Sem, Ham, and Japheth.

The 6th Chapter

And it came to pass, when men began to multiply upon the earth, and had begot them daughters, the sons of God saw the daughters of men that they were fair, and took unto them wives, which they best liked among them all. And the Lord said: My spirit shall not always strive with man, for they are flesh. Nevertheless I will give them yet space, an hundred and twenty years.

There were tyrants in the world in those days. For after that the children of God had gone in unto the daughters of men, and had begotten them children, the same children were the mightiest of the world, and men of renown. And when the Lord saw that the wickedness of man was increased upon the earth, and that all the imagination and thoughts of his heart was only evil continually, he repented that he had made man upon the earth, and sorrowed in his heart. And said: I will destroy mankind which I have made, from off the face of the earth: both man, beast, worm and fowl of the air, for it repents me that I have made them. But yet Noe found grace in the sight of the Lord.

These are the generations of Noe. Noe was a righteous man and uncorrupt in his time, and walked with God. And Noe begat three sons: Sem, Ham, and Japheth. And the earth was corrupt in the sight of God, and was full of mischief. And God looked upon the earth, and lo it was corrupt: for all flesh had corrupted his way upon the earth.

Then said God to Noe: the end of all flesh is come before me, for the earth is full of their mischief. And lo, I will destroy them with the earth. Make you an ark of pine tree, and make chambers in the ark, and pitch it within and without with pitch. And of this fashion shall you make it.

The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits, and the breadth of it fifty cubits, and the height of it thirty cubits. A window shall you make above in the ark. And within a cubit compass shall you finish it. And the door of the ark shall you set in the side of it: and you shall make it with three lofts one above an other. For behold I will bring in a flood of water upon the earth to destroy all flesh from under heaven, wherein breath of life is: so that all that is in the earth shall perish. But I will make mine appointment with you, that both you shall come in to the ark and your sons, your wife and your sons wives with you.

And of all that lives whatsoever flesh it be, shall you bring into the ark, of every thing a pair, to keep them alive with you. And male and female see that they be, of birds in their kind, and of beasts in their kind, and of all manner of worms of the earth in their kind: a pair of every thing shall come unto you to keep them alive. And take unto you of all manner of meat that may be eaten and lay it up in store

by you, that it may be meat both for you and for them: and Noe did according to all that God commanded him.

The 7th Chapter

And the Lord said unto Noe: Go into the ark both you and all your household. For you have I seen righteous before me in this generation. Of all clean beasts take unto you seven of every kind, the male and female, and of unclean beasts a pair, the male and his female: likewise of the birds of the air seven of every kind, male and female to save seed upon all the earth. For seven days from this time will I send rain upon the earth forty days and forty nights, and will destroy all manner of things that I have made, from off the face of the earth.

And Noe did according to all that the Lord commanded him: and Noe was six hundred years old, when the flood of water came upon the earth: and Noe went and his sons and his wife and his sons wives with him, into the ark from the waters of the flood. And of clean beasts, and of beasts that were unclean, and of birds and of all that creeps upon the earth, came in by couples of every kind unto Noe into the ark, a male and a female: even as God commanded Noe. And the seventh day the waters of the flood came upon the earth.

In the six hundredth year of Noes life, in the second month, in the seventeenth day of the month, that same day were all the fountains of the great deep broken up, and the windows of heaven were opened, and there fell a rain upon the earth forty days and forty nights.

And the self same day went Noe, Sem, Ham and Japheth, Noes sons, and Noes wife and the three wives of his sons with them in to the ark: both they and all manner of beasts in their kind, and all manner of cattle in their kind, and all manner of worms that creep upon the earth in their kind, and all manner of birds in their kind, and all manner of fowls whatsoever had feathers. And they came unto Noe into the ark couples, of all flesh that had breath of life in it. And they that came, came male and female of every flesh according as God commanded him: and the Lord shut the door upon him. And the flood came forty days and forty nights upon the earth, and the water increased and bare up the ark, and it was lifted up from off the earth. And the water prevailed and increased exceedingly upon the earth: and the ark went upon the top of the waters. And the waters prevailed exceedingly above measure upon the earth, so that all the high hills which are under all the parts of heaven were covered: even fifteen cubits high prevailed the waters, so that the hills were covered.

And all flesh that moved on the earth both birds, cattle and beasts perished, with all that crept on the earth and all men: so that all that had the breath of life in the nostrils of it throughout all that was on dry land died. Thus was destroyed all that was upon the earth, both man, beasts, worms and fowls of the air, so that they were destroyed from the earth: save Noe was reserved only and they that

were with him in the ark. And the waters prevailed upon the earth, an hundred and fifty days.

The 8th Chapter

And God remembered Noe and all the beasts and all the cattle that were with him in the ark. And God made a wind to blow upon the earth, and the waters ceased: and the fountains of the deep and the windows of heaven were stopped, and the rain of heaven was forbidden, and the waters returned from off the earth, and abated after the end of an hundred and fifty days.

And the ark rested upon the mountains of Ararat, the seventeenth day of the seventh month. And the waters went away, and decreased until the tenth month. And the first day of the tenth month, the tops of the mountains appeared. And after the end of forty days Noe opened the window of the ark which he had made, and sent forth a raven, which went out, ever going and coming again, until the waters were dried up upon the earth.

Then sent he forth a dove from him, to know whether the waters were fallen from off the earth. And when the dove could find no resting place for her foot, she returned to him again unto the ark, for the waters were upon the face of all the earth. And he put out his hand, and took her and pulled her to him into the ark.

And he abode yet seven days more, and sent out the dove again out of the ark, and the dove came to him again about eventide, and behold, there was in her mouth a leaf of an olive tree which she had plucked: whereby Noe perceived that the waters were abated upon the earth. And he tarried yet seven other days, and sent forth the dove, which from then forth came no more again to him.

And it came to pass, the six hundred and one year and the first day of the first month, that the waters were dried up upon the earth. And Noe took off the hatches of the ark, and looked: and behold, the face of the earth was dry. So by the twenty seventh day of the second month the earth was dry.

And God spoke unto Noe, saying: Come out of the ark, both you and your wife and your sons and your sons wives with you. And all the beasts that are with you whatsoever flesh it be, both fowl and cattle, and all manner worms that creep on the earth, bring out with you, and let them move, grow and multiply upon the earth. And Noe came out, and his sons, and his wife, and his sons wives with him. And all the beasts, and all the worms, and all the fowls and all that moved upon the earth, came also out of the ark, all of one kind together.

And Noe made an altar unto the Lord, and took of all manner of clean beasts, and all manner of clean fowls, and offered sacrifice upon the altar. And the Lord smelled a sweet savour and said in his heart: I will from this time forth no more curse the earth for mans sake, for the imagination of mans heart is evil, even from the very youth of him. Moreover I will not destroy from this time forth all that lives

as I have done. Neither shall sowing time and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, day and night cease, as long as the earth endures.

The 9th Chapter

And God blessed Noe and his sons and said unto them: Increase and multiply and fill the earth. The fear also and dread of you be upon all beasts of the earth, and upon all fowls of the air, and upon all that creeps on the earth, and upon all fishes of the sea, which are given unto your hands. And all that moves upon the earth having life, shall be your meat: Even as the green herbs so give I you all things. Only the flesh with his life which is his blood, see that you eat not.

For verily the blood of you wherein your lives are will I require: Even of the hand of all beasts will I require it, and of the hand of man and of the hand of every mans brother will I require the life of man: so that he which sheds mans blood, shall have his blood shed by man again: for God made man after his own likeness. See that you increase, and wax, and be occupied upon the earth, and multiply therein.

Furthermore God spoke unto Noe and to his sons with him, saying: See, I make my bond with you and your seed after you, and with all living things that is with you: both fowl and cattle, and all manner beasts of the earth that is with you, of all that comes out of ark, what soever beast of the earth it be. I make my bond with you, that from this time forth all flesh shall not be destroyed with the waters of any flood, and that from this time forth there shall not be a flood to destroy the earth.

And God said: This is the token of my bond which I make between me and you, and between all living things that is with you for ever: I will set my bow in the clouds and it shall be a sign of the appointment made between me and the earth: so that when I bring in clouds upon the earth, the bow shall appear in the clouds. And then will I think upon my testament which I have made between me and you, and all that lives whatsoever flesh it be. So that from this time forth there shall be no more waters to make a flood to destroy all flesh.

The bow shall be in the clouds, and I will look upon it, to remember the everlasting testament between God and all that lives upon the earth, whatsoever flesh it be. And God said unto Noe: This is the sign of the testament which I have made between me and all flesh that is on the earth.

The sons of Noe that came out of the ark were: Sem, Ham and Japheth. And Ham he is the father of Canaan. These are the three sons of Noe, and of these was all the world overspread.

And Noe being an husbandman, went forth and planted a vineyard, and drank of the wine and was drunk, and lay uncovered in the midst of his tent. And Ham the father of Canaan saw his fathers privities, and told his two brethren that were without. And Sem and Japheth took a mantle, and put it on both their shoulders and went backward, and covered their fathers secrets, but their faces were backward, so that they saw not their fathers nakedness.

As soon as Noe was awakened from his wine, and knew what his youngest son had done unto him, he said: Cursed be Canaan, and a servant of all servants be he to his brethren. And he said: Blessed be the Lord God of Sem, and Canaan be his servant. God increase Japheth that he may dwell in the tents of Sem. And Canaan be their servant.

And Noe lived after the flood three hundred and fifty years: So that all the days of Noe were nine hundred and fifty years, and then he died.

The 10th Chapter

These are the generations of the sons of Noe: of Sem, Ham and Japheth, which begat them children after the flood.

The sons of Japheth were: Gomir, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tuball, Mesech and Thyras. And the sons of Gomir were: Ascenas, Riphath and Togarma. And the sons of Javan were: Elisa, Tharsis, Cithim and Dodanim. Of these came the Isles of the gentiles in their countries, every man in his speech, kindred and nation.

The sons of Ham were: Chus, Misraim, Phut and Canaan. The sons of Chus were Seba, Hevila, Sabta, Raima and Sabtema. And the sons of Raima were: Sheba, and Dedan. Chus also beget Nimrod, which began to be mighty in the earth. He was a mighty hunter in the sight of the Lord: Whereof came the proverb: he is as Nimrod that mighty hunter in the sight of the Lord. And the beginning of his kingdom was Babell, Erech, Achad, and Chalne in the land of Sinear: Out of that land came Assur, and builded Ninive, and the city Rehoboth, and Calah, and Ressen between Nineve and Calah. That is a great city. And Mizrim begat Ludim, Enanim, Leabim, Naphtuhim, Pathrusim and Casluhim: from where came the Philistins, and the Caphtherines.

Canaan also begat Zidon his eldest son and Heth, Jebusi, Emori, Girgosi, Him, Arki, Sini, Arvadi, Zemari and Harmati. And afterward sprang the kindreds of the Cananites. And the coasts of the Cananites were from Sidon till you come to Gerara and to Asa, and till you come to Sodoma, Gomorra, Adama, Zeboim, even unto Lasä. These were the children of Ham in their kindreds, tongues, lands and nations.

And Sem the father of all the children of Eber, and the eldest brother of Japheth begat children also. And his sons were: Elam, Assur, Arphachsad, Lud and Aram. And the children of Aram were: Ur, Hul, Gether and Mas. And Arphachsad begat Sala, and Sala begat Eber. And Eber begat two sons. The name of the one was Peleg, for in his time the earth was divided. And the name of his brother was Jaketan.

Jaketan begat Almodad, Saleph, Hizarmoneth, Jarah, Hadoram, Usal, Dikela, Obal, Abimael, Seba, Ophir, Hevila and Jobab. All these are the sons of Jaketan. And the dwelling of them was from Mesa until you come unto Sephara a mountain of the east land. These are the sons of Sem in their kindreds, languages, countries

and nations. These are the kindreds of the sons of Noe, in their generations and nations. And of these came the people that were in the world after the flood.

The 11th Chapter

And all the world was of one tongue and one language. And as they came from the east, they found a plain in the land of Sinear, and there they dwelled. And they said one to another: come on, let us make brick and burn it with fire. So brick was their stone and slime was their mortar. And they said: Come on, let us build us a city and a tower, that the top may reach unto heaven. And let us make us a name, for peradventure we shall be scattered abroad over all the earth. And the Lord came down to see the city and the tower which the children of Adam had builded. And the Lord said: See, the people is one, and have one tongue among them all: And this have they begun to do, and will not leave off from all that they have purposed to do. Come on, let us descend, and mingle their tongue even there, that one understand not what another says. Thus the Lord scattered them from there upon all the earth. And they left off to build the city. Wherefore the name of it is called Babell, because that the Lord there confounded the tongue of all the world. And because that the Lord from there scattered them abroad upon all the earth.

These are the generations of Sem: Sem was an hundred years old and begat Arphachsad two years after the flood. And Sem lived after he had beget Arphachsad five hundred years and begat sons and daughters.

And Arphachsad lived thirty five years and begat Sala, and lived after he had beget Sala four hundred years and three and begat sons and daughters. And Sala was thirty years old and begat Eber, and lived after he had beget Eber four hundred and three years, and begat sons and daughters. When Eber was thirtyfour years old, he begat Peleg, and lived after he had beget Peleg, four hundred and thirty years, and begat sons and daughters.

And Peleg when he was thirty years old begat Regu, and lived after he had begot Regu two hundred and nine years, and begat sons and daughters. And Regu when he had lived thirty two years begat Serug, and lived after he had begot Serug two hundred and seven years, and begat sons and daughters.

And when Serug was thirty years old, he begat Nahor, and lived after he had begot Nahor two hundred years, and begat sons and daughters. And Nahor when he was twenty nine years old, begat Terah, and lived after he had begot Terah, an hundred and nineteen years, and begat sons and daughters.

And when Terah was seventy years old, he begat Abram, Nahor and Haran.

And these are the generations of Terah. Terah begat Abram, Nahor and Haran. And Haran begat Lot. And Haran died before Terah his father in the land where he was born, at Ur in Chaldea. And Abram and Nahor took them wives. Abrams wife was called Sarai. And Nahors wife Mylca the daughter of Haran which was father of Milca and of Iisca. But Sarai was barren, and had no child.

Then took Terah Abram his son and Lot his son, Harans son, and Sarai his daughter in law, his son Abrams wife. And they went with him from Ur in Chaldea, to go into the land of Chanaan. And they came to Haran and dwelled there. And when Terah was two hundred years old and five he died in Haran.

The 12th Chapter

Then the Lord said unto Abram: Get you out of your country and from thy kindred, and out of your fathers house, into a land which I will show you. And I will make of you a mighty people, and will bless you, and make your name great, that you may be a blessing. And I will bless them that bless you, and curse them that curse you. And in you shall be blessed all the generations of the earth.

And Abram went as the Lord bade him, and Lot went with him. Abram was seventy five years old, when he went out of Haran. And Abram took Sarai his wife and Lot his brothers son, with all their goods which they had gotten, and souls which they had begotten in Haran. And they departed to go into the land of Chanaan. And when they were come into the land of Chanaan, Abram went forth into the land till he came unto a place called Sichem, and unto the oak of More. And the Cananites dwelled then in the land.

Then the Lord appeared unto Abram and said: unto your seed will I give this land. And he builded an altar there unto the Lord which appeared to him. Then departed he there unto a mountain that lies on the east side of Bethel and pitched his tent: Bethel being on the west side, and Ay on the east: and he builded there an altar unto the Lord, and called on the name of the Lord. And then Abram departed and took his journey southward.

After this there came a dearth in the land. And Abram went down into Egypt, to sojourn there, for the dearth was sore in the land. And when he was come near for to enter into Egypt, he said unto Sarai his wife. Behold, I know that you are a fair woman to look upon. It will come to pass therefore when the Egyptians see you, that they will say: she is his wife. And so shall they slay me and save you. Say I pray you therefore that you are my sister, that I may fare the better by reason of you, and that my soul may live for your sake.

As soon as he came into Egypt, the Egyptians saw the woman that she was very fair. And Pharaos lords saw her also, and praised her unto Pharaoh: So that she was taken into Pharaos house, which entreated Abram well for her sake, so that he had sheep, oxen and he asses, men servants, maid servants, she asses and camels.

But God plagued Pharaoh and his house with great plagues, because of Sarai Abrams wife. Then Pharaoh called Abram and said: Why have you thus dealt with me? Wherefore told you me not that she was your wife? Why said you that she was your sister, and caused me to take her to my wife? But now lo, there is your wife, take her and be walking. Pharaoh also gave a charge unto his men over Abram, to lead him out, with his wife and all that he had.

The 13th Chapter

Then Abram departed out of Egypt both he and his wife and all that he had, and Lot with him unto the south. Abram was very rich in cattle, silver and gold. And he went on his journey from the south even unto Bethel, and unto the place where his tent was at the first time between Bethel and Ay, and unto the place of the altar which he made before. And there called Abram upon the name of the Lord.

Lot also which went with him had sheep, cattle and tents: so that the land was not able to receive them that they might dwell together, for the substance of their riches was so great, that they could not dwell together. And there fell a strife between the herdsmen of Abrams cattle, and the herdsmen of Lots cattle. Moreover the Cananites and the Pherisites dwelled at that time in the land. Then said Abram unto Lot: Let there be no strife (I pray you) between you and me, and between my herdsmen and yours, for we be brethren. Is not all the whole land before you? Depart I pray you from me. If you will take the left hand, I will take the right: or if you take the right hand I will take the left. And Lot lift up his eyes, and beheld all the country about Jordan, which was a plenteous country of water every where, before the Lord destroyed Sodom and Gomorra, even as the garden of the Lord, and as the land of Egypt till you come to Zoar.

Then Lot chose all the coasts of Jordan and took his journey from the east. And so departed the one brother from the other. Abram dwelled in the land of Canaan: And Lot in the cities of the plain, and tented till he came to Sodom. But the men of Sodom were wicked and sinned exceedingly against the Lord.

And the Lord said unto Abram, after that Lot was departed from him: Lift up your eyes, and look from the place where you are, northward, southward, eastward and westward, for all the land which you sees will I give unto you and to your seed for ever. And I will make your seed, as the dust of the earth: so that if a man can number the dust of the earth, then shall your seed also be numbered. Arise and walk about in the land, in the length of it and in the breadth, for I will give it unto you. Then Abram took down his tent and went and dwelled in the oak grove of Mamre which is in Ebron, and builded there an altar to the Lord.

The 14th Chapter

And it chanced within a while, that Amraphel king of Sinthr, Arioch king of Ellasar, Kedorlaomer king of Elam and Thydeall king of the nations, made war with Bera king of Sodom, and with Birsas king of Gomorra. And with Sineab king of Adama, and with Semeaber king of Zeboim, and with the king of Bela which Bela is called Zoar. All these came together unto the vale of Siddim, which is now the salt sea. Twelve years were they subject to king Kedorlaomer, and in the thirteenth year rebelled. Therefore in the fourteenth year came Kedorlaomer and the kings that were with him, and smote the Raphaims in Astaroth Karnaim, and the Susims in Ham, and the Emims in Sabe Kariathaim, and the Horims in their own mount

Seir unto the plain of Pharan, which borders upon the wilderness. And then turned they and came to the well of judgement which is Cades, and smote all the country of the Amalekites, and also the Amorites that dwell in Hazezon Tamar.

Then went out the king of Sodom, and the king of Gomorra, and the king of Adama and the king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela now called Zoar. And set their men in the array to fight with them in the vale of Siddim, that is to say, with Kedorlaomer the king of Elam and with Thydeall king of the Nations, and with Amraphel king of Sinear. And with Arioch king of Ellasar: four kings against five. And that vale of Siddim was full of slime pits.

And the kings of Sodom and Gomorra fled, and fell there. And the residue fled to the mountains. And they took all the goods of Sodom and Gomorra and all their victuals, and went their way. And they took Lot also, Abrams brothers son and his goods (for he dwelled at Sodom) and departed. Then came one that had escaped, and told Abram the Hebrew which dwelt in the oak grove of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eschol and Aner: which were confederate with Abram. When Abram heard that his brother was taken, he harnessed his servants born in his own house three hundred and eighteen, and followed till they came at Dan. And set himself and his servants in array, and fell upon them by night, and smote them, and chased them away unto Hoba: which lies on the left hand of Damasco, and brought again all the goods and also his brother Lot, and his goods, the women also and the people.

And as he returned again from the slaughter of Kedorlaomer and of the kings that were with him, then came the king of Sodom to meet him in the vale of Saue, which now is called kings dale.

Then Melchisedech king of Salem brought forth bread and wine. And he being the Priest of the most highest God, blessed him saying: Blessed be Abram unto the most highest God, possessor of heaven and earth. And blessed be God the most highest, which has delivered your enemies into your hands. And Abram gave him tithes of all.

Then said the king of Sodom unto Abram: Give me the souls, and take the goods to your self. And Abram answered the king of Sodom: I lift up my hand unto the Lord God most high possessor of heaven and earth, that I will not take of all that is yours, so much as a thread or a shoe latchet, least you should say, I have made Abram rich. Save only that which the young men have eaten and the parts of the men which went with me. Aner, Eschol and Mamre. Let them take their parts.

The 15th Chapter

After these deeds, the word of God came unto Abram in a vision saying: fear not Abram, I am your shield, and your reward shall be exceeding great. And Abram answered: Lord Jehovah what will you give me: I go childless, and the cater of mine house, this Eleasar of Damasco has a son. And Abram said: See, to me have you

given to seed: lo, a lad born in my house shall be mine heir.

And behold, the word of the Lord spoke unto Abram, saying: He shall not be your heir, but one that shall come out of your own body shall be your heir. And he brought him out of the doors, and said: Look up unto heaven, and tell the stars, if you be able to number them. And said unto him: Even so shall your seed be.

And Abram believed the Lord, and it was counted to him for righteousness. And he said unto him: I am the Lord that brought you out of Ur in Chaldea to give you this land to possess it.

And he said: Lord God, whereby shall I know that I shall possess it? And he said unto him: take an heifer of three years old, and a she goat of three years old, and a three year old ram, a turtle dove and a young pigeon. And he took all these and divided them in the midst, and laid every piece, one against another. But the fowls divided he not. And the birds fell on the carcasses, but Abram drove them away. And when the sun was down, there fell a slumber upon Abram. And lo, fear and great darkness came upon him.

And he said unto Abram: know this of a surety, that your seed shall be a stranger in a land that pertains not unto them. And they shall make bondmen of them and entreat them evil four hundred years. But the nation whom they shall serve, will I judge. And afterward shall they come out with great substance. Nevertheless you shall go unto your fathers in peace, and shall be buried when you are of a good age: and in the fourth generation they shall come *hither (to this) again, for the wickedness of the Amorites is not yet full.

When the sun was down and it was waxed dark: behold, there was a smoking furnace and a fire brand that went between the said pieces.

And that same day the Lord made a covenant with Abram saying: unto your seed will I give this land, from the river of Egypt, even unto the great river Euphrates, the Kenites, the Kenizites, the Cadmonites, the Hethites, the Pherezites, the Raphaims, the Amorites, the Cananites, the Gergesites and the Jebusites.

The 16th Chapter

Sarai Abrams wife bare him no children. But she had an hand maid an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar. Wherefore she said unto Abram: Behold the Lord has closed me, that I cannot bear. I pray you go in unto my maid, peradventure I shall be multiplied by means of her. And Abram heard the voice of Sarai. Then Sarai Abrams wife took Hagar her maid the Egyptian (after Abram had dwelled ten years in the land of Canaan) and gave her to her husband Abram, to be his wife.

And he went in unto Hagar, and she conceived. And when she saw that she had conceived: her mistress was despised in her sight. Then said Sarai unto Abram: You do me unright, for I have given my maid into your bosom: and now because she sees that she has conceived, I am despised in her sight: the Lord judge between you and me. Then said Abram to Sarai: behold, your maid is in your hand,

do with her as it pleases you.

And because Sarai fared foul with her, she fled from her. And the Angel of the Lord found her beside a fountain of water in the wilderness: even by a well in the way to Sur. And he said: Hagar Sarais maid, from where come you and where ever will you go? And she answered: I flee from my mistress Sarai. And the Angel of the Lord said unto her: return to your mistress again, and submit yourself under her hands.

And the angel of the Lord said unto her: I will so increase your seed, that it shall not be numbered for multitude. And the Lords angel said further unto her: see, you are with child and shall bear a son, and shall call his name Ismael: because the Lord has heard your tribulation. He will be a wild man, and his hand will be against every man, and every mans hand against him. And yet shall he dwell fast by all his brethren. And she called the name of the Lord that spoke unto her: you are the God that looks on me, for she said: I have of a surety seen here the back parts of him that sees me. Wherefore she called the well, the well of the living that sees me which well is between Cades and Bared. And Hagar bare Abram a son, and Abram called his sons name which Hagar bare Ismael. And Abram was eighty six years old when Hagar bare him Ismael.

The 17th Chapter

When Abram was ninety years old and nine, the Lord appeared to him saying: I am the almighty God: walk before me and be uncorrupt. And I will make my bond between you and me, and will multiply you exceedingly. And Abram fell on his face. And God talked moreover with him saying: I am, behold my testament is with you, that you shall be a father of many nations. Therefore, shall you no more be called Abram, but your name shall be Abraham: for a father of many nations have I made you, and I will multiply you exceedingly, and will make nations of you: yea and kings shall spring out of you. Moreover I will make my bond between me and you, and your seed after you, in their times to be an everlasting testament, so that I will be God unto you and to your seed after you. And I will give unto you and to your seed after you, the land wherein you are a stranger: even all the land of Canaan, for an everlasting possession, and will be their God.

And God said unto Abraham: See you keep my testament, both you and your seed after you in their times: This is my testament which you shall keep between me and you and your seed after you, that you circumcise all your men children. you shall circumcise the foreskin of your flesh, and it shall be a token of the bond between me and you. And every manchild when it is eight days old, shall be circumcised among you in your generations, and all servants also born at home or bought with money though they be strangers and not of your seed. The servant born in your house, and he also that is bought with money, must needs be circumcised, that my testament may be in your flesh, for an everlasting bond. If

there be any uncircumcised manchild, that has not the foreskin of his flesh cut off, his soul shall perish from his people: because he has broken my testament. And God said unto Abraham. Sarai your wife shall no more be called Sarai: but Sara shall her name be. For I will bless her and give you a son of her and will bless her: so that people, yea and kings of people shall spring of her. And Abraham fell upon his face and laughed, and said in his heart: shall a child be born unto him that is an hundred years old, and shall Sara that is ninety years old, bear: And Abraham said unto God. O that Ismael might live in your sight.

Then said God: no, Sara your wife shall bear you a son in deed and you shall call his name Isaac. And I will make my bond with him, that it shall be an everlasting bond unto his seed after him. And as concerning Ismael also, I have heard your request: lo, I will bless him and increase him, and multiply him exceedingly. Twelve princes shall he beget, and I will make a great nation of him. But my bond will I make with Isaac, which Sara shall bear unto you: even this time twelve month.

And God left off talking with him, and departed up from Abraham. And Abraham took Ismael his son and all the servants born in his house and all that was bought with money as many as were men children among the men of Abrahams house, and circumcised the foreskin of their flesh, even the selfsame day, as God had said unto him. Abraham was ninety years old and nine when he cut off the foreskin of his flesh. And Ismael his son was thirteen years old, when the foreskin of his flesh was circumcised. The self same day was Abraham circumcised and Ismael his son. And all the men in his house, whether they were born in his house or bought with money (though they were strangers) were circumcised with him.

The 18th Chapter

And the Lord appeared unto him in the oak grove of Mamre as he sat in his tent door in the heat of the day. And he lifted up his eyes and looked: and lo, three men stood not far from him. And when he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and fell to the ground and said: Lord if I have found favour in your sight: go not by your servant. Let a little water be fetched, and wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree: And I will fetch a morsel of bread, to comfort your hearts withal. And then go your ways, for even therefore are you come to your servant. And they answered: Do even so as you have said. And Abraham went a pace into his tent unto Sara and said: make ready at once three pecks of fine meal, knead it, and make cakes. And Abraham ran unto his beasts and fetched a calf that was tender and good, and gave it unto a young man which made it ready at once. And he took butter and milk and the calf which he had prepared, and set it before them, and stood himself by them under the tree: and they ate.

And they said unto him: Where is Sara your wife? And he said: in the tent. And he said: I will come again unto you as soon as the fruit can live. And lo: Sara your

wife shall have a son. That heard Sara, out of the tent door which was behind his back. Abraham and Sara were both old and well stricken in age, and it ceased to be with Sara after the manner as it is with wives. And Sara laughed in her self saying: Now I am waxed old, shall I give my self to lust, and my lord old also? Then said the Lord unto Abraham: wherefore does Sara laugh saying: shall I of a surety bear a child, now when I am old? is the thing too hard for the Lord to do? In the time appointed will I return unto you, as soon as the fruit can have life, And Sara shall have a son. Then Sara denied it saying: I laughed not, for she was afraid. But he said: yes you laughed. Then the men stood up from there and looked toward Sodom. And Abraham went with them to bring them on the way. And the Lord said: Can I hide from Abraham that thing which I am about to do, seeing that Abraham shall be a great and a mighty people, and all the nations of the earth shall be blessed in him? For I know him that he will command his children and his household after him, that they keep the way of the Lord, to do after right and conscience, that the Lord may bring upon Abraham that he has promised him.

And the Lord said: The cry of Sodom and Gomorra is great, and their sin is exceeding grievous. I will go down and see whether they have done altogether according to that cry which is come unto me or not, that I may know. And the men departed there and went to Sodomward. But Abraham stood yet before the Lord, and drew near and said. Will you destroy the righteous with the wicked? If there be fifty righteous within the city, will you destroy it and not spare the place for the sake of fifty righteous that are therein? That be far from you, that you should do after this manner, to slay the righteous with the wicked, and that the righteous should be as the wicked: that be far from you. Should not the judge of all the world do according to right? And the Lord said: If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, I will spare all the place for their sakes.

And Abraham answered and said: behold I have taken upon me to speak unto the Lord, and yet am but dust and ashes. What though there lack five of fifty righteous, will you destroy all the city for lack of five? And he said: If I find there forty and five I will not destroy them. And he spoke unto him yet again and said: what if there be forty found there. And he said: I will not do it for fortys sake. And he said: O let not my Lord be angry, that I speak. What if there be found thirty there? And he said: I will not do it, if I find thirty there. And he said: Oh, see, I have begun to speak unto my Lord, what if there be twenty found there? And he said: I will not destroy them for twentys sake. And he said: O let not my Lord be angry, that I speak yet, but even once more only. What if ten be found there? And he said: I will not destroy them for tens sake. And the Lord went his way as soon as he had left communing with Abraham. And Abraham returned unto his place.

The 19th Chapter

And there came two angels to Sodom at even. And Lot sat at the gate of the city.

And Lot saw them, and rose up to meet them, and he bowed himself to the ground with his face. And he said: See lords, turn in I pray you in to your servants house and tarry all night and wash your feet, and rise up early and go on your ways. And they said: no, but we will bide in the streets all night. And he compelled them exceedingly. And they turned in unto him and entered into his house, and he made them a feast and did bake sweet cakes, and they ate. But before they went to rest, the men of the city of Sodom compassed the house round about both old and young, all the people from all quarters. And they called unto Lot and said unto him: where are the men which came into your house to night? bring them out unto us that we may do our lust with them.

And Lot went out at doors unto them and shut the door after him and said: no for Gods sake brethren, do not so wickedly. Behold I have two daughters which have known no man, them will I bring out unto you: do with them as it seems you good: Only unto these men do nothing, for therefore came they under the shadow of my roof. And they said: come hither. And they said: came you not in to sojourn, and will you be now a judge? we will surely deal worse with you than with them.

And as they pressed sore upon Lot and began to break up the door, the men put forth their hands and pulled Lot into the house to them and shut to the door. And the men that were at the door of the house, they smote with blindness both small and great: so that they could not find the door. And the men said moreover unto Lot: If you have yet here any son in law or sons or daughters or whatsoever you have in the city, bring it out of this place: for we must destroy this place, because the cry of them is great before the Lord. Wherefore he has sent us to destroy it.

And Lot went out and spoke unto his sons in law which should have married his daughters, and said: stand up and get you out of this place, for the Lord will destroy the city. But he seemed as though he had mocked, unto his sons in law. And as the morning arose the angels caused Lot to speed him saying. Stand up, take your wife and your two daughters and that, that is at hand, least you perish in the sin of the city. And as he prolonged the time, the men caught both him, his wife and his two daughters by the hands, because the Lord was merciful unto him, and they brought him forth and set him without the city. When they had brought them out, they said: Save your life and look not behind you neither tarry you in any place of the country, but save yourself in the mountain, least you perish. Then said Lot unto them: O no my Lord: behold, inasmuch as your servant has found grace in your sight, now make your mercy great, which you showed unto me in saving my life. For I cannot save myself in the mountains, least some misfortune fall upon me and I die. Behold, here is a city by, to flee unto, and it is a little one, let me save myself therein: is it not a little one, that my soul may live? And he said to him: see I have received your request as concerning this thing, that I will not overthrow this

city for the which you have spoken. Haste you, and save yourself there, for I can do nothing till you be come in to there. And therefore the name of the city is called Zoar. And the sun was upon the earth when Lot was entered into *Zoar. *Zoar = Hebrew: to be brought low, made little.

Then the Lord rained upon Sodom and Gomorra, brimstone and fire from the Lord out of heaven, and overthrew those cities and all the region, and all that dwelled in the cities, and that, that grew upon the earth. And Lots wife looked behind her, and was turned in to a pillar of salt.

Abraham rose up early and got him to the place where he stood before the Lord, and looked toward Sodom and Gomorra and toward all the land of that country. And as he looked: behold, the smoke of the country arose as it had been the smoke of a furnace. But yet when God destroyed the cities of the region, he thought upon Abraham: and sent Lot out from the danger of the overthrowing, when he overthrew the cities where Lot dwelled.

And Lot departed out of Zoar and dwelled in the mountains and his two daughters with him for he feared to tarry in Zoar: he dwelled therefore in a cave, both he and his two daughters also. Then said the elder unto the younger: our father is old, and there are no more men in the earth to come in unto us after the manner of all the world. Come therefore, let us give our father wine to drink, and let us lie with him that we may save seed of our father. And they gave their father wine to drink that same night. And the elder daughter went and lay with her father. And he perceived it not, neither when she lay down, neither when she rose up.

And on the morrow the elder said unto the younger: behold, yesternight lay I with my father. Let us give him wine to drink this night also, and go you and lie with him, and let us save seed of our father. And they gave their father wine to drink that night also. And the younger arose and lay with him. And he perceived it not: neither when she lay down, neither when she rose up. Thus were both the daughters of Lot with child by their father. And the elder bare a son and called him Moab, which is the father of the Moabites unto this day. And the younger bare a son and called him Ben Ammi, which is the father of the children of Ammon unto this day.

The 20th Chapter

And Abraham departed there toward the south country and dwelled between Cades and Sur and sojourned in Gerar. And Abraham said of Sara his wife, that she was his sister. Then Abimelech king of Gerar sent and fetched Sara away.

And God came to Abimelech by night in a dream and said to him: See, you are but a dead man for the womans sake which you have taken away, for she is a man s wife. But Abimelech had not yet come near her, and therefore said: Lord will you slay righteous people? said not he unto me, that she was his sister? yea and said

not she herself that he was her brother? with a pure heart and innocent hands have I done this. And God said unto him in a dream. I know it well that you did it in pureness of your heart. And therefore I kept you that you should not sin against me, neither *suffered (allowed) I you to come near her. Now therefore deliver the man his wife again, for he is a prophet. And let him pray for you that you may live. But and if you deliver her not again, be sure that you shall die the death, with all that you hast.

Then Abimelech rose up be times in the morning and called all his servants, and told all these things in their ears, and the men were sore afraid. And Abimelech called Abraham and said unto him: What have you done unto us, and what have I offended you, that you should bring on me and on my kingdom so great a sin? you have done deeds unto me that ought not to be done. And Abimelech said moreover unto Abraham: What saw you that moved you to do this thing?

And Abraham answered. I thought that peradventure the fear of God was not in this place, and that they should slay me for my wifes sake: yet in very deed she is my sister, the daughter of my father, but not of my mother: and became my wife. And after God caused me to wander out of my fathers house, I said unto her: This kindness shall you show unto me in all places where we come, that you say of me, how that I am your brother.

Then took Abimelech sheep and oxen, menservants and womenservants and gave them unto Abraham, and delivered him Sara his wife again. And Abimelech said: behold the land lies before you, dwell where it pleases you best. And unto Sara he said: See I have given your brother a thousand pieces of silver, behold this thing shall be a covering to your eyes unto all that are with you and unto all men and an excuse.

And so Abraham prayed unto God, and God healed Abimelech and his wife and his maidens, so that they bare. For the Lord had closed too, all the matrices of the house of Abimelech, because of Sara Abrahams wife.

The 21st Chapter

The Lord visited Sara as he had said and did unto her according as he had promised. And Sara was with child and bare Abraham a son in his old age even the same season which the Lord had appointed. And Abraham called his sons name that was born unto him which Sara bare him Isaac and Abraham circumcised Isaac his son when he was eight days old, as God commanded him. And Abraham was an hundred years old, when his son Isaac was born unto him. And Sara said: God has made me a laughing stock: for all that hear, will laugh at me. She said also: who would have said unto Abraham, that Sara should have given children suck, or that I should have borne him a son in his old age: The child grew and was weaned, and Abraham made a great feast, the same day that Isaac was weaned. Sara saw the son of Hagar the Egyptian which she had borne unto Abraham, a mocking.

Then she said unto Abraham: put away this bondmaid and her son: for the son of this bondwoman shall not be heir with my son Isaac: But the word seemed very grievous in Abrahams sight, because of his son. Then the Lord said unto Abraham: let it not be grievous unto you, because of the lad and of your bondmaid: But in all that Sara has said unto you, hear her voice, for in Isaac shall your seed be called. Moreover of the son of the bondwoman will I make a nation, because he is your seed.

And Abraham rose up early in the morning and took bread and a bottle with water, and gave it unto Hagar, putting it on her shoulders with the lad also, and sent her away. And she departed and wandered up and down in the wilderness of Berseba. When the water was spent that was in the bottle, she cast the lad under a bush and went and sat her out of sight a great way, as it were a bowshot off: For she said: I will not see the lad die. And she sat down out of sight, and lifted up her voice and wept.

And God heard the voice of the child. And the angel of God called Hagar out of heaven and said unto her: What ails you Hagar? Fear not, for God has heard the voice of the child where he lies. Arise and lift up the lad, and take him in your hand, for I will make of him a great people. And God opened her eyes and she saw a well of water. And she went and filled the bottle with water, and gave the boy drink. And God was with the lad, and he grew and dwelled in the wilderness, and became an archer. And he dwelled in the wilderness of Pharan. And his mother got him a wife out of the land of Egypt.

And it chanced the same season, that Abimelech and Phicol his chief captain spoke unto Abraham saying: God is with you in all that you do. Now therefore swear unto me even here by God, that you will not hurt me nor my children, nor my children's children. But that you shall deal with me and the country where you are a stranger, according unto the kindness that I have showed you. Then said Abraham: I will swear.

And Abraham rebuked Abimelech for a well of water, which Abimelechs servants had taken away. And Abimelech answered I know not who did it: Also you told me not, neither heard I of it, but this day. And Abraham took sheep and oxen and gave them unto Abimelech. And they made both of them a bond together. And Abraham set seven lambs by themselves. And Abimelech said unto Abraham: what mean these seven lambs which you have set by themselves. And he answered: seven lambs shall you take of my hand, that it may be a witness unto me, that I have digged this well: Wherefore the place is called Berseba, because they sware both of them. Thus made they a bond together at Berseba. Then Abimelech and Phicol his chief Captain rose up and turned again unto the land of the Philistines. And Abraham planted a wood in Berseba, and called there, on the

name of the Lord, the everlasting God: and dwelt in the Philistine land a long season.

The 22nd Chapter

After these deeds, God did prove Abraham and said unto him: Abraham. And he answered: here am I. And he said: take your only son Isaac whom you love, and get you unto the land of Moria, and sacrifice him there for a sacrifice upon one of the mountains which I will show you. Then Abraham rose up early in the morning and saddled his ass, and took two of his *meiny (many/OE mein; like minded) with him, and Isaac his son: and clove wood for the sacrifice, and rose up and got him to the place which God had appointed him.

The third day Abraham lifted up his eyes and saw the place afar off, and said unto his young men: bide here with the ass. I and the lad will go yonder and worship and come again unto you. And Abraham took the wood of the sacrifice and laid it upon Isaac his son, and took fire in his hand and a knife. And they went both of them together.

Then spoke Isaac unto Abraham his father and said: My father? And he answered here am I my son. And he said: See here is fire and wood, but where is the sheep for sacrifice? And Abraham said: my son, God will provide him a sheep for sacrifice. So went they both together.

And when they came unto the place which God showed him, Abraham made an altar there and dressed the wood, and bound Isaac his son and laid him on the altar, above upon the wood. And Abraham stretched forth his hand, and took the knife to have killed his son. Then the angel of the Lord called unto him from heaven saying: Abraham, Abraham? And he answered: here am I. And he said: lay not your hands upon the child, neither do anything at all unto him, for now I know that you fear God, in that you have not kept your only son from me. And Abraham lifted up his eyes and looked about: and behold, there was a ram caught by the horns in a thicket. And he went and took the ram and offered him up for a sacrifice in the stead of his son. And Abraham called the name of the place, the Lord will see: wherefore it is a common saying this day: in the mount will the Lord be seen.

And the angel of the Lord cried unto Abraham from heaven the second time saying: by myself have I sworn (says the Lord) because you have done this thing and have not spared your only son, that I will bless you and multiply your seed as the stars of heaven and as the sand upon the sea side. And your seed shall possess the gates of his enemies. And in your seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed, because you have obeyed my voice. So turned Abraham again unto his young men, and they rose up and went together to Berseba. And Abraham dwelt at Berseba. And it chanced after these things, that one told Abraham saying: Behold, Milcha she has also born children unto your brother Nachor: Hus his eldest son and Bus his brother, and Kemuel the father of the Sirians, and Cesed,

and Haso, and Pildas, and Jedlaph, and Bethuel. And Bethuel begat Rebecca. These eight did Milcha bear to Nachor Abrahams brother. And his concubine called Rheuma she bare also Tebah, Gaham, Thaas and Maacha.

The 23rd Chapter

Sara was an hundred and twenty seven years old (for so long lived she) and then died in a head city called Hebron in the land of Canaan. Then Abraham came to mourn Sara, and to weep for her. And Abraham stood up from the corpse, and talked with the sons of Heth saying: I am a stranger and a foreigner among you, give me a possession to bury in with you, that I may bury my dead out of my sight. And the children of Heth answered Abraham saying unto him: Hear us Lord, you are a prince of God among us. In the chiefest of our sepulchers bury your dead: None of us shall forbid you his sepulcher, that you should not bury your dead therein. Abraham stood up, and bowed himself before the people of the land the children of Heth. And he communed with them saying: If it be your minds that I shall bury my dead out of my sight, hear me and speak for me to Ephron the son of Zoar: and let him give me the double cave which he has in the end of his field, for as much money as it is worth, let him give it me in the presence of you, for a possession to bury in. For Ephron dwelled among the children of Heth.

Then Ephron the Hethite answered Abraham in the audience of the children of Heth and of all that went in at the gates of his city, saying: Not so, my lord, but hear me: The field give I you, and the cave that therein is give I you also: And even in the presence of the sons of my people give I it you to bury your dead in. Then Abraham bowed himself before the people of the land, and spoke unto Ephron in the audience of the people of the country saying: I pray you hear me, I will give silver for the field, take it of me, and so will I bury my dead there. Ephron answered Abraham saying unto him: My lord, hearken unto me. The land is worth four hundred sickles of silver: But what is that between you and me? bury your dead. And Abraham hearkened unto Ephron and weighed him the silver which he had said in the audience of the sons of Heth. Even four hundred silver sickles of current money among merchants. Thus was the field of Ephron wherein the double cave is before Mamre: even the field and the cave that is therein and all the trees of the field which grow in all the borders round about, made sure unto Abraham for a possession, in the sight of the children of Heth, and of all that went in at the gates of the city. And then Abraham buried Sara his wife in the double cave of the field that lies before Mamre, otherwise called Ebron in the land of Canaan. And so both the field and the cave that is therein, was made unto Abraham, a sure possession to bury in, of the sons of Heth.

The 24th Chapter

Abraham was old and stricken in days, and the Lord had blessed him in all

things. And he said unto his eldest servant of his house which had the rule over all that he had: Put your hand under my thigh that I may make you swear by the Lord that is God of heaven and God of the earth, that you shall not take a wife unto my son, of the daughters of the Cananites, among which I dwell. But shall go unto my country and to my kindred, and there take a wife unto my son Isaac.

Then said the servant unto him: what and if the woman will not agree to come with me unto this land, shall I bring your son again unto the land which you came out of? And Abraham said unto him: beware of that, that you bring not my son over there. The Lord God of heaven which took me from my fathers house and from the land where I was born, and which spoke unto me and sware unto me saying: unto your seed will I give this land, he shall send his angel before you, that you may take a wife unto my son from there. Nevertheless if the woman will not agree to come with you then shall you be without danger of this oath. But above all things bring not my son over there again. And the servant put his hand under the thigh of Abraham and sware to him as concerning that matter. And the servant took ten camels of the camels of his master and departed, and had of all manner goods of his master with him, and stood up and went to Mesopotamia, unto the city of Nahor. And made his camels to lie down without the city by a wells side of water, at even: about the time that women come out to draw water, and he said.

Lord God of my master Abraham, send me good speed this day, and show mercy unto my master Abraham. Lo I stand here by the well of water and the daughters of the men of this city will come out to draw water: Now the damsel to whom I say, stoop down your pitcher, and let me drink. If she say: Drink, and I will give your camels drink also, the same is she that you have ordained for your servant Isaac: yea and thereby shall I know that you have showed mercy on my master. And it came to pass before he had left speaking, that Rebecca came out, the daughter of Bethuel, son to Mylca the wife of Nahor Abrahams brother, and her pitcher upon her shoulder: The damsel was very fair to look upon, and yet a maid and unknown of man. And she went down to the well and filled her pitcher and came up again. Then the servant ran unto her and said: let me sip a little water of your pitcher. And she said: drink my lord.

And she hasted and let down her pitcher upon her arm and gave him drink. And when she had given him drink, she said: I will draw water for your camels also, until they have drunk enough. And she poured out her pitcher into the trough hastily, and ran again unto the well, to fetch water: and drew for all his camels. And the fellow wondered at her. But held his peace, to know whether the Lord had made his journey prosperous or not. And as the camels had left drinking, he took an earring of half a sickle weight, and two bracelets for her hands, of ten sickles weight of gold, and said unto her: Whose daughter are you? tell me: is there room in your fathers house, for us to lodge in? And she said unto him: I am the daughter

of Bethuel the son of Mylca which she bare unto Nahor: and said moreover unto him: we have litter (straw) and provender (food/provisions for cattle) enough and also room to lodge in.

And the man bowed himself, and worshiped the Lord, and said: blessed be the Lord God of my master Abraham which ceases not to deal mercifully and truly with my master, And has brought me the way to my masters brothers house. And the damsel ran and told them of her mothers house these things. And Rebecca had a brother called Laban.

And Laban ran out unto the man, to the well: for as soon as he had seen the earrings and the bracelets upon his sisters hands, and heard the words of Rebecca his sister saying thus said the man unto me, then he went out unto the man. And lo, he stood yet with the camels by the well side. And Laban said: come in you blessed of the Lord. Wherefore stand you without? I have dressed the house, and made room for the camels. And then the man came into the house: and he unbridled the camels: and brought litter and provender for the camels, and water to wash his feet and their feet that were with him, and there was meat set before him to eat. But he said: I will not eat, until I have said mine errand. And he said: say on, And he said: I am Abrahams servant, and the Lord has blessed my master out of measure, that he is become great and has given him sheep, oxen, silver and gold, menservants, maidservants, camels and asses. And Sara my masters wife bare him a son, when she was old: and unto him has he given all that he has. And my master made me swear saying: You shall not take a wife to my son among the daughters of the Cananites in whose land I dwell. But you shall go unto my fathers house and to my kindred, and there take a wife unto my son. And I said unto my master: What if the wife will not follow me? And he said unto me: The Lord before whom I walk, will send his angel with you, and prosper your journey that you shall take a wife for my son, of my kindred and of my fathers house. But and if (when you come unto my kindred) they will not give you one, then shall you bear no peril of mine oath.

And I came this day unto the well and said: O Lord, the God of my master Abraham, if it be so that you make my journey which I go, prosperous: behold, I stand by this well of water, and when a virgin comes forth to draw water, and I say to her: give me a little water of your pitcher to drink, and she say again to me: drink you, and I will also draw water for your camels: that same is the wife, whom the Lord has prepared for my masters son.

And before I had made an end of speaking in mine heart: behold Rebecca came forth, and her pitcher on her shoulder, and she went down unto the well and drew. And I said unto her give me drink. And she made haste, and took down her pitcher from off her, and said: drink, and I will give your camels drink also. And I drank, and she gave the camels drink also. And I asked her saying: whose daughter are

you? And she answered: the daughter of Bathuel Nahors son, whom Mylca bare unto him. And I put the earring upon her face and the bracelets upon her hands. And I bowed myself, and worshipped the Lord, and blessed the Lord God of my master Abraham which had brought me the right way, to take my masters brothers daughter unto his son. Now therefore if you will deal mercifully and truly with my master, tell me: And if not, tell me also: that I may turn me to the right hand or to the left.

Then answered Laban and Bathuel saying: The thing is proceeded even out of the Lord, we cannot therefore say unto you, either good or bad: Behold Rebecca before your face, take her and go, and let her be your masters son s wife, even as the Lord has said. And when Abrahams servant heard their words, he bowed himself unto the Lord, flat upon the earth. And the servant took forth jewels of silver and jewels of gold and raiment, and gave them to Rebecca: But unto her brother and to her mother, he gave spices. And then they ate and drank, both he and the men that were with him, and tarried all night and rose up in the morning.

And he said: let me depart unto my master. But her brother and her mother said: let the damsel abide with us a while, and it be but even ten days, and then go your ways. And he said unto them, hinder me not, for the Lord has prospered my journey. Send me away that I may go unto my master. And they said: let us call the damsel, and know what she says to the matter. And they called forth Rebecca, and said unto her: will you go with this man? And she said: Yea.

So they let Rebecca their sister go with her nurse and Abrahams servant, and the men that were with him. And they blessed Rebecca, and said unto her: You are our sister, grow into thousand thousands, and your seed possess the gates of their enemies. And Rebecca arose and her damsels, and sat them up upon the camels, and went their way after the man. And the servant took Rebecca, and went his way.

And Isaac was a coming from the well of the living and seeing, for he dwelt in the south country, and was gone out to walk in his meditations before the even tide. And he lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold the camels were coming. And Rebecca lifted up her eyes, and when she saw Isaac, she lighted off the camel, and said unto the servant: what man is this that comes against us in the field? And the servant said: it is my master. And then she took her mantle, and put it about her. And the servant told Isaac all that he had done. Then Isaac brought her in to his mother Saras tent, and took Rebecca, and she became his wife, and he loved her: and so was Isaac comforted over his mother.

The 25th Chapter

Abraham took him another wife called Ketura, which bare him Simran, Jackson, Medan, Midian, Jesback and Suah. And Jackson begat Seba and Dedan. And the sons of Dedan were Assurim, Letusim and Leumim. And the sons of Midian were

Epha, Ephraim, Hanoch, Abida and Elda. All these were the children of Ketura. But Abraham gave all that he had unto Isaac. And unto the sons of his concubines he gave gifts, and sent them away from Isaac his son (while he yet lived) eastward, unto the east country.

These are the days of the life of Abraham which he lived: an hundred and seventy five years and then fell sick and died, in a lusty age (when he had lived enough) and was put unto his people. And his sons Isaac and Ismael buried him in the double cave in the field of Ephron son of Zoar the Hethite before Mamre. Which field Abraham bought of the sons of Heth: There was Abraham buried and Sara his wife. And after the death of Abraham God blessed Isaac his son, which dwelled by the well of the living and seeing.

These are the generations of Ismael Abrahams son, which Hagar the Egyptian Saras handmaid bare unto Abraham. And these are the names of the sons of Ismael, with their names in their kindreds. The eldest son of Ismael, Nevaioth, then Cedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, Misma, Duma, Masa, Hadar, Thema, Jetur, Naphis and Kedma. These are the sons of Ismael, and these are their names, in their towns and castles twelve princes of nations. And these are the years of the life of Ismael, an hundred and thirty seven years, and then he fell sick and died, and was laid unto his people. And he dwelt from Evila unto Sur that is before Egypt, as men go toward the Assyrians. And he died in the presence of all his brethren.

And these are the generations of Isaac Abrahams son: Abraham begat Isaac. And Isaac was forty years old when he took Rebecca to wife the daughter of Bethuel the Sirian of Mesopotamia and sister to Laban the Sirian.

And Isaac made intercession unto the Lord for his wife: because she was barren: and the Lord was entreated of him, and Rebecca his wife conceived: and the children strove together within her. Then she said: if it should go so to pass, what helps it that I am with child? And she went and asked the Lord. And the Lord said unto her: there are two manner of people in your womb, and two nations shall spring out of your bowels, and the one nation shall be mightier than the other, and the eldest shall be servant unto the younger.

And when her time was come to be delivered: behold there were two twins in her womb. And he that came out first was red and rough over all as it were an hide: and they called his name Esau. And afterward his brother came out, and his hand holding Esau by the heel. Wherefore his name was called Jacob. And Isaac was forty years old when she bare them: and the boys grew, and Esau became a cunning hunter and a tillman. But Jacob was a simple man, and dwelled in the tents. Isaac loved Esau, because he did eat of his venison, but Rebecca loved Jacob.

Jacob boiled pottage, and Esau came from the field and was fainty, and said to Jacob: let me sip of the red pottage, for I am fainty. And therefore was his name called Edom. And Jacob said: sell me this day your birthright. And Esau answered:

Lo I am at the point to die, and what profit shall this birthright do me? And Jacob said: swear to me then this day. And he swore to him, and sold his birthright unto Jacob. Then Jacob gave Esau bread and pottage of red rice. And he ate and drank and rose up, and went his way. And so Esau regarded not his birthright.

The 26th Chapter

And there fell a dearth in the land, passing the first dearth that fell in the days of Abraham. Wherefore Isaac went unto Abimelech king of the Philistines unto Gerar. Then the Lord appeared unto him, and said: go not down into Egypt, but bide in the land which I say unto you: sojourn in this land, and I will be with you, and will bless you: for unto you and unto your seed I will give all these countries. And I will perform the oath which I swore unto Abraham your father, and will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven, and will give unto your seed all these countries. And through your seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed, because that Abraham hearkened unto my voice and kept mine ordinances, commandments, statutes and laws.

And Isaac dwelled in Gerar. And the men of the place asked him of his wife, and he said that she was his sister: for he feared to call her his wife, least the men of the place should have killed him for her sake, because she was beautiful to the eye. And it happened after he had been there long time, that Abimelech king of the Philistines looked out at a window, and saw Isaac sporting with Rebecca his wife. And Abimelech sent for Isaac, and said: see, she is of a surety your wife, and why said you that she was your sister? And Isaac said unto him: I thought that I might peradventure have died for her sake. Then said Abimelech: why have you done this unto us? one of the people might lightly have lain by your wife, and so should you have brought sin upon us. Then Abimelech charged all his people, saying: he that touches this man or his wife, shall surely die for it.

And Isaac sowed in the land, and found in the same year an hundred bushels: for the Lord blessed him, and the man waxed mighty, and went forth and grew till he was exceeding great, that he had possession of sheep, of oxen and a mighty household: so that the Philistines had envy at him: Insomuch that they stopped and filled up with earth, all the wells which his fathers servants digged in his father Abrahams time. Then said Abimelech unto Isaac: get you from me, for you are mightier than we a great deal. Then Isaac departed there, and pitched his tent in the valley Gerar, and dwelt there. And Isaac digged again, the wells of water which they digged in the days of Abraham his father, which the Philistines had stopped after the death of Abraham, and gave them the same names which his father gave them. As Isaacs servants digged in the valley, they found a well of living water. And the herdsmen of Gerar did strive with Isaacs herdsmen saying: the water is ours. Then called he the well Eseck, because they strove with him.

Then digged they another well, and they strove for that also. Therefore called

he it Sitena. And then he departed there, and digged another well for the which they strove not: therefore called he it Rehoboth, saying: the Lord has now made us room, and we are increased upon the earth. Afterward departed he there and came to Berseba. And the Lord appeared unto him the same night, and said: I am the God of Abraham your father, fear not for I am with you, and will bless you, and multiply your seed for my servant Abrahams sake. And then he builded an altar there, and called upon the name of the Lord, and there pitched his tent. And there Isaacs servants digged a well.

Then came Abimelech to him from Gerar and Ahusath his friend and Phicol his chief captain. And Isaac said unto them: wherefore come you to me, seeing you hate me and have put me away from you? Then said they: we saw that the Lord was with you, and therefore we said that there should be an oath between us and you, and that we would make a bond with you, that you should do us no hurt, as we have not touched you, and have done unto you nothing but good, and send you away in peace: for you are now the blessed of the Lord. And he made them a feast, and they ate and drank. And they rose up by times in the morning, and sware one to another. And Isaac sent them away. And they departed from him in peace. And the same day came Isaacs servants, and told him of a well which they had digged: and said unto him, that they had found water. And he called it Seba, wherefore the name of the city is called Berseba unto this day.

The 27th Chapter

When Esau was forty years old, he took to wife Judith the daughter of Bery an Hethite, and Basmath the daughter of Elon an Hethite also, which were disobedient unto Isaac and Rebecca. And it came to pass that Isaac waxed old and his eyes were dim, so that he could not see. Then called he Esau his eldest son and said unto him: my son. And he said unto him: here am I. And he said: behold, I am old and know not the day of my death: Now therefore take your weapons, your quiver and your bow, and get you to the fields, and take me some venison, and make me meat such as I love, and bring it me, and let me eat that my soul may bless you before that I die. But Rebecca heard when Isaac spoke to Esau his son. And as soon as Esau was gone to the field to catch venison, and to bring it, she spoke unto Jacob her son saying: Behold I have heard your father talking with Esau your brother and saying: bring me venison and make me meat, that I may eat and bless you before the Lord before I die. Now therefore my son hear my voice in that which I command you: get you to the flock, and bring me here two good kids, and I will make meat of them for your father, such as he loves. And you shall bring it to your father, and he shall eat, that he may bless you before his death.

Then said Jacob to Rebecca his mother: Behold Esau my brother is rough and I am smooth. My father shall peradventure feel me, and I shall seem unto him as though I went about to beguile him, and so shall he bring a curse upon me, and

not a blessing: and his mother said unto him. Upon me be your curse my son, only hear my voice, and go and fetch me them. And Jacob went and fetched them, and brought them to his mother. And his mother made meat of them, according as his father loved. And she went and fetched goodly raiment of her eldest son Esau, which she had in the house with her, and put them upon Jacob her youngest son, and she put the skins upon his hands and upon the smooth of his neck. And she put the meat and bread which she had made in the hand of her son Jacob.

And he went in to his father saying: my father? And he answered: here am I, who are you my son? And Jacob said unto his father: I am Esau your eldest son, I have done according as you bade me: up and sit and eat of my venison, that your soul may bless me. But Isaac said unto his son: How comes it that you have found it so quickly my son? He answered: The Lord your God brought it to my hand. Then said Isaac unto Jacob: come near and let me feel you my son, whether you be my son Esau or not. Then went Jacob to Isaac his father, and he felt him and said: the voice is Jacobs voice, but the hands are the hands of Esau. And he knew him not, because his hands were rough as his brother Esaus hands and so he blessed him.

And he asked him: are you my son Esau? And he said: that I am. Then said he: bring me and let me eat of my sons venison, that my soul may bless you. And he brought him, and he ate. And he brought him wine also, and he drank. And his father Isaac said unto him: come near and kiss me my son. And he went to him and kissed him. And he smelled the savour of his raiment and blessed him, and said: See, the smell of my son is as the smell of a field which the Lord has blessed. God give you of the dew of heaven, and of the fatness of the earth, and plenty of corn and wine. People be your servants, and nations bow unto you. Be lord over your brethren, and your mothers children stoop unto you. Cursed be he that curses you, and blessed be he that blesses you.

As soon as Isaac had made an end of blessing, Jacob was scarce gone out from the presence of Isaac his father: then came Esau his brother from his hunting, and had made also meat, and brought it in unto his father, and said unto him: Arise my father, and eat of your sons venison, that your soul may bless me. Then his father Isaac said unto him: Who are you? he answered: I am your eldest son Esau. And Isaac was greatly astoned (astonished) out of measure, and said: Where is he then that has hunted venison and brought it me, and I have eaten of all before you came, and have blessed him, and he shall be blessed still. When Esau heard the words of his father, he cried out greatly and bitterly above measure, and said unto his father: bless me also my father. And he said: your brother came with subtlety, and has taken away your blessing. Then said he: He may well be called Jacob, for he has undermined me now two times, first he took away my birthright: and see, now has he taken away my blessing also. And he said, have you kept never a blessing for me?

Isaac answered and said unto Esau: behold I have made him your lord, and all his mothers children have I made his servants. Moreover with corn and wine have I stablished him, what can I do unto you now my son? And Esau said unto his father: have you but that one blessing my father? bless me also my father: so lifted up Esau his voice and wept. Then Isaac his father answered and said unto him: Behold your dwelling place shall have of the fatness of the earth, and of the dew of heaven from above. And with your sword shall you live, and shall be your brothers servant. But the time will come, when you shall get the mastery, and loose his yoke from off your neck.

And Esau hated Jacob, because of the blessing that his father blessed him withal, and said in his heart: The days of my fathers sorrow are at hand, for I will slay my brother Jacob. And these words of Esau her eldest son, were told to Rebecca. And she sent and called Jacob her youngest son, and said unto him: behold your brother Esau threatens to kill you: Now therefore my son hear my voice, make you ready, and flee to Laban my brother at Haran: And tarry with him a while, until your brothers fierceness be assuaged (less intense), and until your brothers wrath turn away from you, and he forget that which you have done to him. Then will I send and fetch you away from there. Why should I lose you both in one day? And Rebecca spoke to Isaac: I am weary of my life, for fear of the daughters of Heth. If Jacob take a wife of the daughters of Heth, such one as these are, or of the daughters of the land, what lust should I have to live?

The 28th Chapter

Then Isaac called Jacob his son and blessed him, and charged him, and said unto him: see you take not a wife of the daughters of Canaan, but arise and get you to Mesopotamia to the house of Bethuel your mothers father: and there take you a wife of the daughters of Laban your mothers brother. And God almighty bless you, increase you, and multiply you that you may be a number of people, and give you the blessing of Abraham: both to you and to your seed with you, that you may possess the land (wherein you are a stranger) which God gave unto Abraham. Thus Isaac sent forth Jacob, to go to Mesopotamia unto Laban, son of Bethuel the Sirien, and brother to Rebecca Jacobs and Esaus mother.

When Esau saw that Isaac had blessed Jacob, and sent him to Mesopotamia, to fetch him a wife there, and that as he blessed him he gave him a charge, saying: see you take not a wife of the daughters of Canaan: and that Jacob had obeyed his father and mother, and was gone unto Mesopotamia: and seeing also that the daughters of Canaan pleased not Isaac his father: Then went he unto Ismael, and took unto the wives which he had, Mahala the daughter of Ismael Abrahams son, the sister of Nabaioth to be his wife. Jacob departed from Berseba and went toward Haran, and came unto a place, and tarried there all night, because the sun was down. And took a stone of the place, and put it under his head, and laid him

down in the same place to sleep. And he dreamed: and behold there stood a ladder upon the earth, and the top of it reached up to heaven. And see, the angels of God went up and down upon it, yea and the Lord stood upon it and said:

I am the Lord God of Abraham your father, and the God of Isaac: The land which you sleep upon will I give you and your seed. And your seed shall be as the dust of the earth: And you shall spread abroad: west, east, north and south. And through you and your seed shall all the kindreds of the earth be blessed. And see I am with you, and will be your keeper in all places where ever you go, and will bring you again into this land: Neither will I leave you until I have made good all that I have promised you.

When Jacob was awakened out of his sleep, he said: surely the Lord is in this place, and I was not aware. And he was afraid and said: how fearful is this place? it is none other, but even the house of God and the gate of heaven. And Jacob stood up early in the morning, and took the stone that he had laid under his head, and pitched it up on end, and poured oil on the top of it. And he called the name of the place Bethell, for indeed the name of the city was called Lus before time. And Jacob vowed a vow, saying: If God will be with me, and will keep me in this journey which I go, and will give me bread to eat, and clothes to put on, so that I come again unto my fathers house in safety: then shall the Lord be my God, and this stone which I have set up on end, shall be Gods house: And of all that you shall give me, will I give the tenth unto you.

The 29th Chapter

Then Jacob lifted up his feet, and went toward the east country. And as he looked about, behold there was a well in the field, and three flocks of sheep lay thereby (for at that well were the flocks watered) and there lay a great stone at the well mouth. And the manner was to bring the flocks over there, and to roll the stone from the wells mouth, and to water the sheep, and to put the stone again upon the wells mouth unto his place. And Jacob said unto them: brethren, from where be ye? And they said: of Haran are we. And he said unto them: Know you Laban the son of Nahor? And they said: We know him. And he said unto them: is he in good health? And they said: he is in good health: and behold, his daughter Rahel comes with the sheep. And he said: lo, it is yet a great while to night, neither is it time that the cattle should be gathered together: water the sheep, and go and feed them. And they said: we may not, until all the flocks be brought together, and the stone be rolled from the wells mouth, and so we water our sheep.

While he yet talked with them, Rahel came with her fathers sheep, for she kept them. As soon as Jacob saw Rahel, the daughter of Laban his mothers brother, and the sheep of Laban his mothers brother, he went and rolled the stone from the wells mouth, and watered the sheep of Laban his mothers brother. And Jacob kissed Rahel, and lifted up his voice and wept: and told her also that he was her

fathers brother and Rebeccas son. Then Rahel ran and told her father. When Laban heard tell of Jacob his sisters son, he ran to meet him, and embraced him and kissed him, and brought him into his house. And then Jacob told Laban all the matter. And then Laban said: well, you are my bone and my flesh. Abide with me the space of a month. And afterward Laban said unto Jacob: though you be my brother, should you therefore serve me for naught? tell me what shall your wages be? And Laban had two daughters, the eldest called Lea and the youngest Rahel. Lea was tender eyed, but Rahel was beautiful and well favored. And Jacob loved her well, and said: I will serve you seven years for Rahel your youngest daughter. And Laban answered: it is better that I give her you, than to another man: bide therefore with me.

And Jacob served seven years for Rahel, and they seemed unto him but a few days, for the love he had to her. And Jacob said unto Laban: give me my wife, that I may lie with her. For the time appointed me is come.

Then Laban bade all the men of that place, and made a feast. And when even was come, he took Lea his daughter and brought her to him: and he went in unto Her. And Laban gave unto his daughter Lea, Zilpha his maid, to be her servant. And when the morning was come, behold it was Lea. Than said he to Laban: wherefore have you played thus with me? did not I serve you for Rahel, wherefore then have you beguiled me? Laban answered: it is not the manner of this place, to marry the youngest before the eldest. Pass out this week, and then shall this also be given you for the service which you shall serve me yet seven years more. And Jacob did even so, and passed out that week, and then he gave him Rahel his daughter to wife also. And Laban gave to Rahel his daughter, Bilha his handmaid to be her servant. So lay he by Rahel also, and loved Rahel more than Lea, and served him yet seven years more.

When the Lord saw that Lea was despised, he made her fruitful: but Rahel was barren. And Lea conceived and bare a son, and called his name Ruben, for she said: the Lord has looked upon my tribulation. And now my husband will love me. And she conceived again and bare a son, and said: the Lord has heard that I am despised, and has therefore given me this son also, and she called him Simeon. And she conceived yet, and bare a son, and said: now this once will my husband keep me company, because I have borne him three sons: and therefore she called his name Levi. And she conceived yet again, and bare a son saying: Now will I praise the Lord: therefore she called his name Juda, and left bearing.

The 30th Chapter

When Rahel saw that she bare Jacob no children, she envied her sister, and said unto Jacob: give me children, or else I am but dead. Then was Jacob wroth with Rahel saying: Am I in Gods stead which keeps from you the fruit of your womb? Then she said: here is my maid Bilha: go in unto her, that she may bear upon my

lap, that I may be increased by her. And she gave him Bilha her handmaid to wife. And Jacob went in unto her: And Bilha conceived and bare Jacob a son. Then said Rahel: God has given sentence on my side, and has also heard my voice, and has given me a son. Therefore called she him Dan. And Bilha Rahels maid conceived again, and bare Jacob another son. And Rahel said. God is turned, and I have made a change with my sister, and have gotten the upper hand. And she called his name: Naphtali.

When Lea saw that she had left bearing, she took Silpha her maid, and gave her Jacob to wife. And Silpha Leas maid bare Jacob a son. Then said Lea: Good luck: and called his name Gad. And Silpha Leas maid bare Jacob another son. Then said Lea: happy am I, for the daughters will call me blessed. And called his name Asser.

And Ruben went out in the wheat harvest and found mandragoras in the fields, and brought them unto his mother Lea. Then said Rahel to Lea give me of your sons mandragoras. And Lea answered: Is it not enough, that you have taken away my husband, but would take away my sons mandragoras also? Then said Rahel: well, let him sleep with you this night, for your sons mandragoras. And when Jacob came from the fields at even, Lea went out to meet him, and said: come in to me, for I have bought you with my sons mandragoras.

And he slept with her that night. And God heard Lea, that she conceived and bare unto Jacob the fifth son. Then said Lea: God has given me my reward, because I gave my maiden to my husband, and she called him Isachar. And Lea conceived yet again, and bare Jacob the sixth son. Then said she: God has endued me with good dowry. Now will my husband dwell with me, because I have borne him six sons: and called his name Zabulon. After that she bare a daughter, and called her Dina.

And God remembered Rahel, heard her, and made her fruitful: so that she conceived and bare a son, and said: God has taken away my rebuke. And she called his name Joseph saying: The Lord give me yet another son. As soon as Rahel had borne Joseph, Jacob said to Laban: Send me away that I may go unto mine own place and country, give me my wives and my children for whom I have served you, and let me go: for you know what service I have done you. Then said Laban unto him: If I have found favour in your sight (for I suppose that the Lord has blessed me for your sake) appoint what your reward shall be, and I will give it you. But he said unto him: you know what service I have done you, and in what taking your cattle have been under me: For it was but little that you had before I came, and now it is increased into a multitude, and the Lord has blessed you for my sake. But now when shall I make provision for mine own house also? And he said: what shall I give you? And Jacob answered: you shall give me nothing at all, if you will do this one thing for me: And then will I turn again, and feed your sheep and keep them.

I will go about all your sheep this day, and separate from them all the sheep

that are spotted and of diverse colors, and all black sheep among the lambs, and the party and spotted among the kids: And the same shall be my reward. So shall my righteousness answer for me: when the time comes that I shall receive my reward of you: So that whatsoever is not speckled and party among the goats and black among the lambs, let that be theft with me. Then said Laban: Lo, I am content, that it be according as you have said. And he took out that same day the he goats that were party and of diverse colors, and all the goats that were spotted and party colored, and all that had white in them, and all the black among the lambs: and put them in the keeping of his sons, and set three days journey between himself and Jacob. And so Jacob kept the rest of Labans sheep.

Jacob took rods (thin branch) of green poplar, hazel, (lt/yellow brown) and of chestnut (reddish brown) trees, and pilled (peeled) white streaks in them and made the white appear in the staves: And he put the staves which he had pilled, even before the sheep, in the gutters and watering troughs, when the sheep came to drink: that they should conceive when they came to drink. And the sheep conceived before the staves, and brought forth streaked, spotted and party. Then Jacob parted the lambs and turned the faces of the sheep toward spotted things, and toward all manner of black things throughout the flocks of Laban. And he made him flocks of his own by them self, which he put not unto the flocks of Laban. And always in the first bucking time of the sheep, Jacob put the staves before the sheep in the gutters, that they might conceive before the staves: But in the latter bucking time, he put them not there: so the last brood was Labans and the first Jacobs. And the man became exceeding rich and had many sheep, maidservants, menservants, camels and asses.

The 31st Chapter

And Jacob heard the words of Labans sons how they said: Jacob has taken away all that was our fathers, and of our fathers goods, has he gotten all this honor. And Jacob beheld the countenance of Laban, that it was not toward him as it was in times past. And the Lord said unto Jacob: turn again into the land of your fathers and to your kindred, and I will be with you. Then Jacob sent and called Rahel and Lea to the field unto his sheep, and said unto them: I see your fathers countenance that it is not toward me as in times past. Moreover the God of my father has been with me. And you know how that I have served your father with all my might. And your father has deceived me, and changed my wages ten times: But God allowed him not to hurt me. When he said, the spotted shall be your wages, then all the sheep bare spotted. If he said, the streaked shall be your reward, then bare all the sheep streaked: thus has God taken away your fathers cattle and given them me. For in bucking time, I lifted up mine eyes and saw in a dream, and behold, the rams that bucked the sheep were streaked, spotted and party. And the angel of God spoke unto me in a dream saying: Jacob? And I answered: here am I. And he

said: lift up your eyes and see, how all the rams that leap upon the sheep are streaked, spotted and party: for I have seen all that Laban does unto you. I am the God of Bethel where you anointed the stone, and where you vowed a vow unto me. Now arise and get you out of this country, and return unto the land where you was born.

Then answered Rahel and Lea, and said unto him: we have no part nor inheritance in our fathers house: he counts us even as strangers, for he has sold us, and has even eaten up the price of us. Moreover all the riches which God has taken from our father, that is ours and our childrens. Now therefore whatsoever God has said unto you, that do. Then Jacob rose up, and set his sons and wives up upon camels, and carried away all his cattle and all his substance which he had gotten in Mesopotamia, for to go to Isaac his father unto the land of Canaan. Laban was gone to shear his sheep, and Rahel had stolen her fathers images. And Jacob stole away the heart of Laban the Sirian, and told him not that he fled. So fled he and all that he had, and made himself ready, and passed over the rivers, and set his face straight toward the mount Gilead.

Upon the third day after, was it told Laban that Jacob was fled. Then he took his brethren with him and followed after him seven days journey, and overtook him at the mount Gilead. And God came to Laban the Sirian in a dream by night, and said unto him: take heed to yourself, that you speak not to Jacob anything save good. And Laban overtook Jacob: and Jacob had pitched his tent in that mount. And Laban with his brethren pitched their tent also upon the mount Gilead. Then said Laban to Jacob: why have you this done to steal away my heart, and carry away my daughters as though they had been taken captive with sword? Wherefore went you away secretly unknown to me, and did not tell me, that I might have brought you on the way with mirth, singing, timbrels and harps, and have not allowed me to kiss my children and my daughters? You was a fool to do it, for I am able to do you evil. But the God of your father spoke unto me yesterday saying: take heed that you speak not to Jacob anything save good. And now though you went your way because you long after your fathers house, yet wherefore have you stolen my gods?

Jacob answered and said to Laban: because I was afraid, and thought that you would have taken away your daughters from me. But with whomsoever you find your gods, let him die here before our brethren. Seek that your is by me, and take it to you: for Jacob knew not that Rahel had stolen them. Then went Laban into Jacobs tent, and into Leas tent, and into two maidens tents: but found them not. Then went he out of Leas tent, and entered into Rahels tent. And Rahel took the images, and put them in the camels straw, and sat down upon them. And Laban searched all the tent: but found them not. Then said she to her father: my lord, be not angry that I cannot rise up before you, for the disease of women is come upon

me. So searched he, but found them not.

Jacob was wroth, and chode (scold mildly) with Laban. Jacob also answered and said to him: what have I trespassed or what have I offended, that you followed after me? You have searched all my stuff, and what have you found of all your household stuff? put it here before your brethren and mine, and let them judge between us both. This twenty years that I have been with you, your sheep and your goats have not been barren, and the rams of your flock have I not eaten. Whatsoever was torn of beasts I brought it not unto you, but made it good myself: of my hand did you require it, whether it was stolen by day or night. Moreover by day the heat consumed me, and the cold by night, and my sleep departed from mine eyes.

Thus have I been twenty years in your house, and served you fourteen years for your two daughters, and six years for your sheep, and you have changed my reward ten times. And except the God of my father, the God of Abraham, and the God whom Isaac fears had been with me: surely you had sent me away now all empty. But God beheld my tribulation, and the labor of my hands: and rebuked you yesterday.

Laban answered and said unto Jacob: the daughters are my daughters, and the children are my children, and the sheep are my sheep, and all that you see is mine. And what can I do this day unto these my daughters, or unto their children which they have born? Now therefore come on, let us make a bond, I and you together, and let it be a witness between you and me. Then took Jacob a stone and set it up on end, and said unto his brethren, gather stones. And they took stones, and made an heap, and they ate there upon the heap. And Laban called it Zegar Sahadutha, but Jacob called Gilead.

Then said Laban: this heap be witness between you and me this day (therefore is it called Gilead) and this toot hill which the Lord sees (said he) be witness between me and you when we are departed one from another: that you shall not vex my daughters neither shall take other wives unto them. Here is no man with us: behold, God is witness between you and me. And Laban said moreover to Jacob: behold, this heap and this mark which I have set here, between me and you: this heap be witness and also this mark, that I will not come over this heap to you, and you shall not come over this heap and this mark, to do any harm. The God of Abraham, the God of Nahor, and the God of their fathers, be judge between us.

And Jacob sware by him that his father Isaac feared. Then Jacob did sacrifice upon the mount, and called his brethren to eat bread. And they ate bread and tarried all night in the hill. And early in the morning Laban rose up and kissed his children and his daughters, and blessed them and departed and went unto his place again. But Jacob went forth on his journey. And the angels of God came and

met him. And when Jacob saw them, he said: this is Gods host: and called the name of that same place, Mahanaim.

The 32nd Chapter

Jacob sent messengers before him to Esau his brother, unto the land of Seir and the field of Edom. And he commanded them saying: see that you speak after this manner to my lord Esau: your servant Jacob says thus. I have sojourned and been a stranger with Laban unto this time and have gotten oxen, asses and sheep, menservants and womenservants, and have sent to show it my lord, that I may find grace in your sight. And the messengers came again to Jacob saying: we came unto your brother Esau, and he comes against you and four hundred men with him. Then was Jacob greatly afraid, and knew not which way to turn himself, and divided the people that was with him and the sheep, oxen and camels, into two companies, and said: If Esau come to the one part and smite it, the other may save itself.

And Jacob said: O God of my father Abraham, and God of my father Isaac: Lord, which said unto me, return unto your country and to your kindred, and I will deal well with you. I am not worthy of the least of all the mercies and truth which you have showed unto your servant. For with my staff came I over this Jordan, and now have I gotten two droves. Deliver me from the hands of my brother Esau: for I fear him: least he will come and smite the mother with the children. You said that you would surely do me good, and would make my seed as the sand of the sea which cannot be numbered for multitude.

And he tarried there that same night, and took of that which came to hand, a present, unto Esau his brother: Two hundred she goats and twenty he goats: two hundred sheep and twenty rams: thirty milk camels with their colts: forty kine and ten bulls: twenty she asses and ten foals and delivered them unto his servants, every drove by themselves, and said unto them: go forth before me and put a space between every drove. And he commanded the foremost, saying:

When Esau my brother meets you and asks you saying: whose servant are you and where goes you, and whose are these that go before you: you shall say, they be your servant Jacobs, and are a present sent unto my lord Esau, and behold, he himself comes after us. And so commanded he the second, and even so the third, and likewise all that followed the droves saying, of this manner see that you speak unto Esau when you meet him, and say moreover. Behold your servant Jacob comes after us, for he said. I will pease his wrath with the present that goes before me and afterward I will see him myself, so peradventure he will receive me to grace. So went the present before him and he tarried all that night in the tent, and rose up the same night and took his two wives and his two maidens and his eleven sons, and went over the ford Jabok. And he took them and sent them over the river, and sent over that he had and tarried behind himself alone.

And there wrestled a man with him unto the breaking of the day. And when he saw that he could not prevail against him, he smote him under the thigh, and the sinew of Jacobs thigh shrank as he wrestled with him. And he said: let me go, for the day breaks. And he said: I will not let you go, except you bless me. And he said unto him: what is your name? He answered: Jacob. And he said: you shall be called Jacob no more, but Israel. For you have wrestled with God and have prevailed.

And Jacob asked him saying, tell me your name. And he said, wherefore do you ask after my name? and he blessed him there. And Jacob called the name of the place Pheniel, for I have seen God face to face, and yet is my life reserved. And as he went over Peniel, the sun rose upon him, and he halted upon his thigh: wherefore the children of Israel eat not of the sinew that shrank under the thigh, unto this day: because that he smote Jacob under the thigh in the sinew that shrank.

The 33rd Chapter

Jacob lifted up his eyes and saw his brother Esau come, and with him four hundred men. And he divided the children unto Lea and unto Rahel and unto the two maidens. And he put the maidens and their children foremost, and Lea and her children after, and Rahel and Joseph hindermost. And he went before them and fell on the ground seven times, until he came unto his brother.

Esau ran to meet him and embraced him and fell on his neck and kissed him, and they wept. And he lifted up his eyes and saw the wives and their children, and said: what are these which you there hast? And he said: they are the children which God has given your servant. Then came the maidens forth, and did their obeisance. Lea also and her children came and did their obeisance. And last of all came Joseph and Rahel and did their obeisance.

And he said: what mean you with all the droves which I met? And he answered: to find grace in the sight of my lord. And Esau said: I have enough my brother, keep that you have unto yourself. Jacob answered: oh no, but if I have found grace in your sight, receive my present of my hand: for I have seen your face as though I had seen the face of God: wherefore receive me to grace and take my blessing that I have brought you, for God has given it me. And I have enough of all things. And so he compelled him to take it. And he said: let us take our journey and go, and I will go in your company. And he said unto him: my lord knows that I have tender children, ewes and kine with young, under mine hand, which if men should overdrive but even one day, the whole flock would die. Let my lord therefore go before his servant and I will drive fair and softly, according as the cattle that go before me and the children, be able to endure: until I come to my lord unto Seir.

And Esau said: let me yet leave some of my folk with you. And he said: what need is it? let me find grace in the sight of my lord. So Esau went his way again the same day unto Seir. And Jacob took his journey toward Sucoth, and built him an

house, and made booths for his cattle: whereof the name of the place is called Sucoth.

And Jacob came peaceably in to the city of Sichem in the land of Canaan, after that he was come from Mesopotamia, and pitched before the city, and bought a parcel of ground where he pitched his tent, of the children of Hemor Sichems father, for an hundred lambs, And he made there an altar, and there called upon the mighty God of Israel.

The 34th Chapter

Dina the daughter of Lea which she bare unto Jacob, went out to see the daughters of the land. And Sichem the son of Hemor the Hevite lord of the country, saw her and took her, and lay with her, and forced her: and his heart lay unto Dina the daughter of Jacob. And he loved the damsel and spoke kindly unto her, and spoke unto his father Hemor saying, get me this maiden unto my wife. And Jacob heard that he had defiled Dina his daughter, but his sons were with the cattle in the field, and therefore he held his peace, until they were come. Then Hemor the father of Sichem went out unto Jacob, to commune with him. And the sons of Jacob came out of the field as soon as they heard it, for it grieved them, and they were not a little wroth, because he had wrought folly in Israel, in that he had lain with Jacobs daughter, which thing ought not to be done. And Hemor communed with them saying: the soul of my son Sichem longs for your daughter: give her him to wife, and make marriages with us: give your daughters unto us, and take our daughters unto you, and dwell with us, and the land shall be at your pleasure, dwell and do your business, and have your possessions therein. And Sichem said unto her father and her brethren: let me find grace in your eyes, and whatsoever you appoint me, that will I give. Ask freely of me both the dowry and gifts, and I will give according as you say unto me, and give me the damsel to wife.

Then the sons of Jacob answered to Sichem and Hemor his father deceitfully, because he had defiled Dina their sister. And they said unto them, we cannot do this thing that we should give our sister to one that is uncircumcised, for that were a shame unto us. Only in this will we consent unto you: If you will be as we be, that all the men children among you be circumcised, then will we give our daughter to you and take yours to us, and will dwell with you and be one people. But and if you will not hearken unto us to be circumcised, than will we take our daughter and go our ways. And their words pleased Hemor: and Sichem his son. And the young man deferred not for to do the thing, because he had a lust to Jacobs daughter: he was also most set by of all that were in his fathers house. Then Hemor and Sichem went unto the gate of their city, and communed with the men of their city saying: These men are peaceable with us, and will dwell in the land and do their occupation therein. And in the land is room enough for them, let us take their daughters to wives and give them ours: only herein will they consent unto us for to

dwell with us and to be one people: if all the men children that are among us be circumcised as they are. Their goods and their substance and all their cattle are ours, only let us consent unto them, that they may dwell with us.

And unto Hemor and Sichem his son hearkened all that went out at the gate of his city. And all the men children were circumcised whatsoever went out at the gates of his city. And the third day when it was painful to them, two of the sons of Jacob, Simeon and Levi Dinas brethren, took either of them his sword and went into the city boldly, and slew all that was male, and slew also Hemor and Sichem his son with the edge of the sword, and took Dina their sister out of Sichems house, and went their way.

Then came the sons of Jacob upon the deed, and spoiled the city, because they had defiled their sister: and took their sheep, oxen, asses and whatsoever was in the city and also in the fields. And all their goods, all their children and their wives took they captive, and made havoc of all that was in the houses.

And Jacob said to Simeon and Levi: you have troubled me and made me stink unto the inhabitants of the land, both to the Cananites and also unto the Pherezites. And I am few in number. Wherefore they shall gather themselves together against me and slay me, and so shall I and my house be destroyed. And they answered: should they deal with our sister as with an whore?

The 35th Chapter

And God said unto Jacob, arise and get you up to Bethel, and dwell there. And make there an altar unto God that appeared unto you, when you fled from: Esau your brother. Then said Jacob unto his household and to all that were with him, put away the strange gods that are among you and make yourselves clean, and change your garments, and let us arise and go up to Bethel, that I may make an altar there, unto God which heard me in the day of my tribulation and was with me in the way which I went.

And they gave unto Jacob all the strange gods which were under their hands, and all their earrings which were in their ears, and Jacob hid them under an oak at Sichem. And they departed. And the fear of God fell upon the cities that were round about them, that they durst not follow after the sons of Jacob. So came Jacob to Lus in the land of Canaan, otherwise called Bethell, with all the people that was with him. And he builded there an altar, and called the place Bethel: because that God appeared unto him there, when he fled from his brother.

Then died Debora Rebeccas nurse, and was buried beneath Bethel under an oak. And the name of it was called the oak of lamentation. And God appeared unto Jacob again after he came out of Mesopotamia and blessed him and said unto him: your name is Jacob. Notwithstanding you shall be no more called Jacob, but Israel shall be your name. And so was his name called Israel.

And God said unto him: I am God almighty, grow and multiply: for people and a

multitude of people shall spring of you, yea and kings shall come out of your loins. And the land which I gave Abraham and Isaac, will I give unto you, and unto your seed after you will I give it also. And God departed from him in the place where he talked with him. And Jacob set up a mark in the place where he talked with him: even a pillar of stone, and poured drink offering thereon and poured also oil thereon, and called the name of the place where God spoke with him Bethel.

And they departed from Bethel, and when he was but a field breadth from Ephrath, Rahel began to travail. And in travailing she was in peril. And as she was in pains of her labor, the midwife said unto her: fear not, for you shall have this son also. Then as her soul was departing, that she must die: she called his name Ben Oni. But his father called him Ben Jamin. and thus died Rahel and was buried in the way to Ephrath which now is called Bethlehem. And Jacob set up a pillar upon her grave, which is called Rahels grave pillar unto this day. And Israel went then and pitched up his tent beyond the tower of Eder. And it chanced as Israel dwelt in that land, that Ruben went and lay with Bilha his fathers concubine, and it came to Israels ear. The sons of Jacob were twelve in number. The sons of Lea: Ruben, Jacobs eldest son, and Simeon, Levi, Juda, Isachar, and Zabulon. The sons of Rahel: Joseph and Ben Jamin. The sons of Bilha Rahels maid: Dan and Nephtali. The sons of Zilpha Leas maid Gad and Asser. These are the sons which were born him in Mesopotamia.

Then Jacob went unto Isaac his father to Mamre a principal city, otherwise called Hebron: where Abraham and Isaac sojourned as strangers. And the days of Isaac were an hundred and eighty years: and then fell he sick and died, and was put unto his people being old and full of days. And his sons Esau and Jacob buried him.

The 36th Chapter

These are the generations of Esau which is called Edom. Esau took his wives of the daughters of Canaan: Ada the daughter of Elon an Hethite, and Ahalibama the daughter of Ana, which Ana was the son of Zibeon an Hevite, And Basmath Ismaels daughter and sister of Nebaioth. And Ada bare unto Esau, Eliphas: and Basmath bare Reguel: And Ahalibama bare Jeus, Jaelam and Korah. These are the sons of Esau which were born him in the land of Canaan.

And Esau took his wives, his sons and daughters and all the souls of his house: his goods and all his cattle and all his substance which he had got in the land of Canaan, and went into a country away from his brother Jacob: for their riches was so much, that they could not dwell together, and that the land wherein they were strangers, could not receive them: because of their cattle. Thus dwelt Esau in mount Seir, which Esau is called Edom. These are the generations of Esau father of the Edomites in mount Seir, and these are the names of Esaus sons: Eliphas the son of Ada the wife of Esau, and Reguel the son of Basmath the wife of Esau also.

And the sons of Eliphas were: Theman, Omar, Zepho, Gaetham and Kenas. And Thimna was concubine to Eliphas Esaus son, and bare unto Eliphas, Amalek. And these be the sons of Ada Esaus wife. And these are the sons of Reguel: Nahas, Serah, Samma and Misa: these were the sons of Basmath Esaus wife. And these were the sons of Ahalibama Esaus wife the daughter of Ana son of Zebeon, which she bare unto Esau: Jeus, Jaelam and Rorah.

These were dukes of the sons of Esau. The children of Eliphas the first son of Esau were these: duke Theman, duke Omar, duke Zepho, duke Kenas, duke Rorah, duke Gaetham and duke Amaleck: these are the dukes that came of Eliphas in the land of Edom, and these were the sons of Ada. These were the children of Reguel Esaus son: duke Nahas, duke Serah, duke Samma, duke Misa. These are the dukes that came of Reguel in the land of Edom, and these were the sons of Basmath Esaus wife. These were the children of Ahalibama Esaus wife: duke Jeus, duke Gaelam, duke Korah, these dukes came of Ahalibama the daughter of Ana Esaus wife. These are the children of Esau, and these are the dukes of them: which Esau is called Edom: These are the children of Seir the Horite, the inhabiter of the land: Lothan, Sobal, Zibeon, Ana, Dison, Eser and Disan. These are the dukes of the Horites the children of Seir in the land of Edom. And the children of Lothan were: Hori and Hemam. And Lothans sister was called Thimna.

The children of Sobal were these: Alvan, Manahas, Ebal, Sepho and Onam. These were the children of Zibeon. Aia and Ana, this was that Ana that found the mules in the wilderness, as he fed his father Zibeons asses. The children of Ana were these. Dison and Ahalibama the daughter of Ana. These are the children of Dison. Hemdan, Esban, Jethran, and Cheran. The children of Ezer were these, Bilhan, Seavan and Akan. The children of Disan were: Ur and Aran.

These are the dukes that came of Hori: duke Lothan, duke Sobal, duke Zibeon, duke Ana, duke Dison, duke Ezer, duke Disan. These be the dukes that came of Hori in their dukedoms in the land of Seir. These are the kings that reigned in the land of Edom before there reigned any king among the children of Israel. Bela the son of Beor reigned in Edomea, and the name of his city was Dinhaba. And when Bela died, Jobab the son of Serah out of Bezara, reigned in his stead. When Jobab was dead, Husam of the land of Themany reigned in his stead. And after the death of Husam, Hadad the son of Bedad which slew the Madianites in the field of the Moabites, reigned in his stead, and the name of his city was Avith. When Hadad was dead, Samla of Masreka reigned in his stead. When Samla was dead, Saul of the river Rehoboth reigned in his stead. When Saul was dead, Baal Hanan the son of Achbor reigned in his stead. And after the death of Baal Hanan the son of Achbor, Hadad reigned in his stead, and the name of his city was Pagu. And his wifes name Mehetabeel the daughter of Matred the daughter of Mesaab.

These are the names of the dukes that came of Esau, in their kindreds, places

and names: Duke Thimma, duke Alua, duke Jetheth, duke Ahalibama, duke Ela, duke Pinon, duke Kenas, duke Theman, duke Mibzar, duke Magdiel, duke Iram. These be the dukes of Edomea in their habitations, in the land of their possessions. This Esau is the father of the Edomites.

The 37th Chapter

And Jacob dwelt in the land wherein his father was a stranger, that is to say in the land of Canaan. And these are the generations of Jacob: when Joseph was seventeen years old, he kept sheep with his brethren, and the lad was with the sons of Bilha and of Zilpha his fathers wives. And he brought unto their father an evil saying that was of them. And Israel loved Joseph more than all his children, because he begat him in his old age, and he made him a coat of many colors.

When his brethren saw that their father loved him more than all his brethren, they hated him and could not speak one kind word unto him. Moreover Joseph dreamed a dream and told it his brethren: wherefore they hated him yet the more. And he said unto them: hear I pray you this dream which I have dreamed: Behold we were making sheaves in the field: and lo, my sheaf arose and stood upright, and yours stood round about and made obeisance to my sheaf. Then said his brethren unto him: what, shall you be our king or shall you reign over us? And they hated him yet the more, because of his dream and of his words.

And he dreamed yet another dream and told it his brethren saying: behold, I have had one dream more: me thought the *sonne (son) and the moon and eleven stars made obeisance to me. And when he had told it unto his father and his brethren, his father rebuked him and said unto him: what means this dream which you have dreamed: shall I and your mother and your brethren come and fall on the ground before you? And his brethren hated him, but his father noted the saying.

* sonne is exactly the way it appears in the original text, sun, spelled sunne; in middle English, is used else where in the text.

His brethren went to keep their fathers sheep in Sichem, and Israel said unto Joseph: do not your brethren keep in Sichem? come that I may send you to them. And he answered here am I. And he said unto him: go and see whether it be well with your brethren and the sheep, and bring me word again. And sent him out of the vale of Hebron, for to go to Sichem. And a certain man found him wandering out of his way in the field, and asked him what he sought. And he answered: I seek my brethren, tell me I pray you where they keep sheep. And the man said, they are departed here, for I heard them say let us go unto Dothan. Thus went Joseph after his brethren, and found them in Dothan.

And when they saw him afar off before he came at them, they took counsel against him, for to slay him, and said one to another, Behold this dreamer comes, come now and let us slay him and cast him into some pit, and let us say that some

wicked beast has devoured him, and let us see what his dreams will come to.

When Ruben heard that, he went about to rid him out of their hands and said, let us not kill him. And Ruben said moreover unto them, shed not his blood, but cast him into this pit that is in the wilderness, and lay no hands upon him: for he would have rid him out of their hands and delivered him to his father again.

And as soon as Joseph was come unto his brethren, they stripped him out of his gay coat that was upon him, and they took him and cast him into a pit. But the pit was empty and had no water therein. And they sat them down to eat bread. And as they lift up their eyes and looked about, there came a company of Ismaelites from Gilead, and their camels laden with spicery, balm, and myrrh, and were going down into Egypt.

Then said Juda to his brethren, what avails it that we slay our brother, and keep his blood secret? come on, let us sell him to the Ismaelites, and let not our hands be defiled upon him: for he is our brother and our flesh. And his brethren were content. Then as the Madianites merchant men passed by, they drew Joseph out of the pit and sold him unto the Ismaelites for twenty pieces of silver. And they brought him into Egypt.

And when Ruben came again unto the pit and found not Joseph there, he rent his clothes and went again unto his brethren saying: the lad is not yonder, and *whither shall I go? And they took Josephs coat and killed a goat, and dipped the coat in the blood. And they sent that gay coat and caused it to be brought unto their father and said: This have we found: see, whether it be your sons coat or no. And he knew it saying: it is my sons coat: a wicked beast has devoured him, and Joseph is rent in pieces. And Jacob rent his clothes, and put sack cloth about his loins, and sorrowed for his son a long season. Then came all his sons and all his daughters to comfort him. And he would not be comforted, but said: I will go down into the grave unto my son, mourning. And thus his father wept for him. And the Madianites sold him in Egypt unto Putiphar a lord of Pharaos: and his chief marshal. *whither=what ever place, result, or condition.

The 38th Chapter

And it fortun'd at that time that *Judas went from his brethren and got him to a man called Hira of Odollam, and there he saw the daughter of a man called Sua a Cananite. And he took her and went in unto her. And she conceived and bare a son and called his name Er. And she conceived again and bare a son and called him Onan. And she conceived the third time and bare a son, whom she called Sela: and he was at Chesib when she bare him. *Judas (exact spelling)

And Judas gave Er his eldest son, a wife whose name was Tamar. But this Er Judas eldest son was wicked in the sight of the Lord, wherefore the Lord slew him. Then said Judas unto Onan: go in to your brothers wife and marry her, and stir up seed unto your brother. And when Onan perceived that the seed should not be his:

therefore when he went in to his brothers wife, he spilled it on the ground, because he would not give seed unto his brother. And the thing which he did, displeased the Lord, wherefore he slew him also. Then said Juda to Tamar his daughter in law: remain a widow at your fathers house, till Sela my son be grown: for he feared lest he should have died also, as his brethren did. Thus went Tamar and dwelt in her fathers house.

And in process of time, the daughter of Sua Judas wife died. Then Judas when he had left mourning, went unto his sheep shearers to Timnath with his friend Hira of Odollam. And one told Tamar saying: behold, your father in law goes up to Timnath, to shear his sheep. And she put her widows garments off from her and covered her with a cloak, and disguised herself: And sat her down at the entering of Enaim which is by the high ways side to Timnath, for because she saw that Sela was grown, and she was not given unto him to wife.

When Juda saw her he thought it had been an whore, because she had covered her face. And turned to her unto the way and said, come I pray you, let me lie with you, for he knew not that it was his daughter in law. And she said what will you give me, for to lie with me? Then said he, I will send you a kid from the flock. She answered, Then give me a pledge till you send it. Then said he, what pledge shall I give you? And she said: your signet, your bracelet, and your staff that is in your hand. And he gave it her and lay by her, and she was with child by him. And she got her up and went and put her mantle from her, and put on her widows raiment again. And Judas sent the kid by his neighbor of Odollam, for to fetch out his pledge again from the wifes hand. But he found her not. Then asked he the men of the same place saying: where is the whore that sat at Enaim in the way? And they said: there was no whore here. And he came to Juda again saying: I cannot find her, and also the men of the place said: that there was no whore there. And Juda said: let her take it to her, lest we be shamed: for I sent the kid and you could not find her.

And it came to pass that after three months, one told Juda saying: Tamar your daughter in law has played the whore, and with playing the whore is become great with child. And Juda said: bring her forth and let her be burnt. And when they brought her forth, she sent to her father in law saying: by the man unto whom these things pertain, am I with child. And said also: look whose are this seal, bracelet, and staff. And Juda knew them saying: she is more righteous than I, because I gave her not to Sela my son. But he lay with her no more.

When time was come that she should be delivered, behold there was two twins in her womb. And as she travailed, the one put out his hand and the midwife took and bound a red thread about it saying: this will come out first. But he plucked his hand back again, and his brother came out. And she said: wherefore have you rent

a rent upon you? and called him Pharez. And afterward came out his brother that had the red thread about his hand, which was called Zarah.

The 39th Chapter

Joseph was brought unto Egypt, and Putiphar a lord of Pharaos: and his chief marshal an Egyptian, bought him of the Ismaelites which brought him there. And the Lord was with Joseph, and he was a lucky fellow and continued in the house of his master the Egyptian. And his master saw that the Lord was with him, and that the Lord made all that he did prosper in his hand: Wherefore he found grace in his masters sight, and served him. And his master made him ruler of his house, and put all that he had in his hand. And as soon as he had made him ruler over his house and over all that he had, the Lord blessed this Egyptians house for Josephs sake, and the blessing of the Lord was upon all that he had: both in the house and also in the fields. And therefore he left all that he had in Josephs hand, and looked upon nothing that was with him, save only on the bread which he ate. And Joseph was a goodly person and well favored. And it fortun'd after this, that his masters wife cast her eyes upon Joseph and said: come lie with me. But he denied and said to her: Behold, my master knows not what he has in the house with me, but has committed all that he has to my hand. He himself is not greater in the house than I, and has kept nothing from me, but only you because you are his wife. How then can I do this great wickedness, for to sin against God? And after this manner spoke she to Joseph day by day: but he hearkened not unto her, to sleep near her or to be in her company.

And it fortun'd about the same season, that Joseph entered into the house, to do his business: and there was none of the household by, in the house. And she caught him by the garment saying: come sleep with me. And he left his garment in her hand and fled and got him out. When she saw that he had left his garment in her hand, and was fled out, she called unto the men of the house, and told them saying: See, he has brought in an Hebrew unto us to do us shame: for he came in to me, for to have slept with me. But I cried with a loud voice. And when he heard, that I lifted up my voice and cried, he left his garment with me and fled away and got him out.

And she laid up his garment by her, until her lord came home. And she told him according to these words saying. This Hebrews servant which you have brought unto us came in to me to do me shame. But as soon as I lifted up my voice and cried, he left his garment with me and fled out. When his master heard the words of his wife which she told him saying: after this manner did your servant to me, he waxed wroth.

And he took Joseph and put him in prison: even in the place where the kings prisoners lay bound. And there continued he in prison, but the Lord was with Joseph and showed him mercy, and got him favour in the sight of the keeper of the

prison which committed to Josephs hand all the prisoners that were in the prison house. And whatsoever was done there, that did he. And the keeper of the prison looked unto nothing that was under his hand, because the Lord was with him, and because that whatsoever he did, the Lord made it come luckily to pass.

The 40th Chapter

And it chanced after this, that the chief butler of the king of Egypt and his chief baker had offended their lord the king of Egypt. And Pharaos was angry with them and put them in ward in his chief marshals house: even in the prison where Joseph was bound. And the chief marshal gave Joseph a charge with them, and he served them. And they continued a season in ward.

And they dreamed either of them in one night: both the butler and the baker of the king of Egypt which were bound in the prison house, either of them his dream, and each mans dream of a sundry (various) interpretation. When Joseph came in unto them in the morning, and looked upon them: behold, they were sad. And he asked them saying, wherefore look you so sadly today? They answered him, we have dreamed a dream, and have no man to declare it. And Joseph said unto them. Interpreting belongs to God but tell me yet. And the chief butler told his dream to Joseph and said unto him. In my dream me thought there stood a vine before me, and in the vine were three branches, and it was as though it budded, and her blossoms shot forth: and the grapes thereof waxed ripe. And I had Pharaos cup in my hand, and took of the grapes and wrung them into Pharaos cup, and delivered Pharaos cup into his hand. And Joseph said unto him, this is the interpretation of it. The three branches are three days: for within three days shall Pharaos lift up your head, and restore you unto your office again, and you shall deliver Pharaos cup into his hand, after the old manner, even as you did when you was his butler. But think on me with you, when you are in good case, and show mercy unto me. And make mention of me to Pharaos, and help to bring me out of this house: for I was stolen out of the land of the Hebrews, and here also have I done nothing at all wherefore they should have put me into this dungeon. When the chief baker saw that he had well interpreted it, he said unto Joseph, me thought also in my dream, that I had three wicker baskets on my head. And in the uppermost basket of all manner bakemeats for Pharaos. And the birds ate them out of the basket upon my head.

Joseph answered and said: this is the interpretation thereof. The three baskets are three days, for this day three days shall Pharaos take your head from you, and shall hang you on a tree, and the birds shall eat your flesh from off you.

And it came to pass the third day which was Pharaos birthday, that he made a feast unto all his servants. And he lifted up the head of the chief butler and of the chief baker among his servants. And restored the chief butler unto his butlership again, and he reached the cup into Pharaos hand, and hanged the chief baker:

even as Joseph had interpreted unto them. Notwithstanding the chief butler remembered not Joseph, but forgot him.

The 41st Chapter

And it fortun'd at two years end, that Pharaoh dream'd, and thought that he stood by a rivers side, and that there came out of the river seven goodly kine (cows) and fat fleshed, and fed in a meadow, and him thought that seven other kine came up after them out of the river evil favored and lean fleshed and stood by the other upon the brink of the river. And the evil favored and lean fleshed kine: ate up the seven well favored and fat kine: and he awoke therewith. And he slept again and dream'd the second time, that seven ears of corn grew upon one stalk rank and goodly. And that seven thin ears blasted with the wind, sprang up after them: and that the seven thin ears devoured the seven rank and full ears. And then Pharaoh awakened: and see, here is his dream. When the morning came, his spirit was troubled. And he sent and called for all the soothsayers of Egypt and all the wise men thereof, and told them his dream: but there was none of them that could interpret it unto Pharaoh. Then spoke the chief butler unto Pharaoh saying. I do remember my fault this day. Pharaoh was angry with his servants, and put in ward in the chief marshals house both me and the chief baker. And we dream'd both of us in one night and each mans dream of a sundry (various) interpretation.

And there was with us a young man, an Hebrew born, servant unto the chief marshal. And we told him, and he declared our dreams to us according to either of our dreams. And as he declared them unto us, even so it came to pass. I was restored to mine office again, and he was hanged.

Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph. And they made him haste out of prison. And he shaved himself and changed his raiment, and went in to Pharaoh. And Pharaoh said unto Joseph: I have dream'd a dream and no man can interpret it, but I have heard say of you that as soon as you hear a dream, you do interpret it. And Joseph answered Pharaoh saying: God shall give Pharaoh an answer of peace without me. Pharaoh said unto Joseph: in my dream me thought I stood by a rivers side, and there came out of the river seven fat fleshed and well favored kine (cows), and fed in the meadow. And then seven other kine came up after them, poor and very evil favored and lean fleshed: so that I never saw their like in all the land of Egypt in evil favoredness. And the seven lean and evil favored kine ate up the first seven fat kine. And when they had eaten them up, a man could not perceive that they had eaten them: for they were still as evil favored as they were at the beginning. And I awoke. And I saw again in my dream seven ears spring out of one stalk full and good, and seven other ears withered, thin and blasted with wind, spring up after them. And the thin ears devoured the seven good ears. And I have told it unto the soothsayers, but no man can tell me what it means. Then Joseph said unto Pharaoh: both Pharaohs dreams are one. And God does show Pharaoh what he is about to do.

The seven good kine are years: and the seven good ears are seven years also, and is but one dream. Likewise, the seven thin and evil favored kine that came out after them, are seven years: and the seven empty and blasted ears shall be seven years of hunger. This is that which I said unto Pharaoh, that God does show Pharaoh what he is about to do.

Behold there shall come seven years of great plenteousness throughout all the land of Egypt. And there shall arise after them seven years of hunger. So that all the plenteousness shall be forgotten in the land of Egypt. And the hunger shall consume the land: so that the plenteousness shall not be once seen in the land by reason of that hunger that shall come after, for it shall be exceeding great. And as concerning that the dream was doubled unto Pharaoh the second time, it betokens that the thing is certainly prepared of God, and that God will shortly bring it to pass.

Now therefore let Pharaoh provide for a man of understanding and wisdom, and set him over the land of Egypt. And let Pharaoh make officers over the land, and take up the fifth part of the land of Egypt in the seven plenteous years and let them gather all the food of these good years that come, and lay up corn under the power of Pharaoh: that there may be food in the cities, and there let them keep it: that there may be food in store in the land, against the seven years of hunger which shall come in the land of Egypt, and that the land perish not through hunger.

And the saying pleased Pharaoh and all his servants. Then said Pharaoh unto his servants: where shall we find such a man as this is, that has the spirit of God in him? wherefore Pharaoh said unto Joseph: forasmuch as God has showed you all this, there is no man of understanding nor of wisdom like unto you. You therefore shall be over my house, and according to your word shall all my people obey: only in the king's seat will I be above you. And he said unto Joseph: behold, I have set you over all the land of Egypt. And he took off his ring from his finger, and put it upon Joseph's finger, and arrayed him in raiment of byss (fine linen), and put a golden chain about his neck and set him upon the best chariot that he had save one. And they cried before him *Abrech, and that Pharaoh had made him ruler over all the land of Egypt. *Abrech= cap A is correct, may be from Abroach 1. positioned so that a liquid, such as wine, can be let out. 2. In a state of action; astir.

And Pharaoh said unto Joseph: I am Pharaoh, without your will, shall no man lift up either his hand or foot in all the land of Egypt. And he called Joseph's name Zaphnath Paenea. And he gave him to wife Asnath the daughter of Putiphar priest of On. Then went Joseph abroad in the land of Egypt. And he was thirty years old when he stood before Pharaoh king of Egypt. And then Joseph departed from Pharaoh, and went throughout all the land of Egypt.

And in the seven plenteous years they made sheaves and gathered up all the

food of the seven plenteous years which were in the land of Egypt and put it into the cities. And he put the food of the fields that grew round about every city: even in the same. And Joseph laid up corn in store, like unto the sand of the sea in multitude out of measure, until he left numbering: For it was without number. And unto Joseph were born two sons before the years of hunger came, which Asnath the daughter of Putiphar priest of On, bare unto him. And he called the name of the first son Manasse, for God (said he) has made me forget all my labor and all my fathers household. The second called he Ephraim, for God (said he) has caused me to grow in the land of my trouble.

And when the seven years of plenteousness that was in the land of Egypt were ended, then came the seven years of dearth, according as Joseph had said. And the dearth was in all lands: but in the land of Egypt was there yet food. When now all the land of Egypt began to hunger, then cried the people to Pharaoh for bread. And Pharaoh said unto all Egypt: go unto Joseph, and what he says to you that do. And when the dearth was throughout all the land, Joseph opened all that was in the cities, and sold unto the Egyptians. And hunger waxed sore in the land of Egypt. And all countries came to Egypt to Joseph for to buy corn: because that the hunger was so sore in all lands.

The 42nd Chapter

When Jacob saw that there was corn to be sold in Egypt, he said unto his sons: why are you negligent? behold, I have heard that there is corn to be sold in Egypt. Get you there and buy us corn from there, that we may live and not die. So went Josephs ten brethren down to buy corn in Egypt, for Ben Jamin Josephs brother would not Jacob send with his other brethren: for he said: some misfortune might happen him.

And the sons of Israel came to buy corn among other that came, for there was dearth also in the land of Canaan. And Joseph was governor in the land, and sold corn to all the people of the land. And his brethren came, and fell flat on the ground before him. When Joseph saw his brethren, he knew them: But made strange unto them, and spoke roughly unto them saying: From where come ye? and they said: out of the land of Canaan, to buy victual. Joseph knew his brethren, but they knew not him.

And Joseph remembered his dreams which he dreamed of them, and said unto them: you are spies, and to see where the land is weak is your coming. And they said unto him: no, my lord: but to buy victual your servants are come. We are all one mans sons, and mean truly, and your servants are no spies. And he said unto them: no verily, but even to see where the land is weak is your coming. And they said: we your servants are twelve brethren, the sons of one man in the land of Canaan. The youngest is yet with our father, and one no man knows where he is. Joseph said unto them, that is it that I said unto you, that you are surely spies.

Here by you shall be proved. For by the life of Pharaos, you shall not go from here, until your youngest brother be come hither. Send therefore one of you and let him fetch your brother, and you shall be in prison in the mean season. And thereby shall your words be proved, whether there be any truth in you: or else by the life of Pharaos, you are but spies. And he put them in ward three days.

And Joseph said unto them the third day: This do and live, for I fear God. If you mean no hurt, let one of your brethren be bound in the prison, and go you and bring the necessary food unto your households, and bring your youngest brother unto me: that your words may be believed, and that you die not. And they did so.

Then they said one to another: we have verily sinned against our brother, in that we saw the anguish of his soul when he besought us, and would not hear him: therefore is this trouble come upon us. Ruben answered them saying: said I not unto you that you should not sin against the lad? but you would not hear. And now verily see, his blood is required. They were not aware that Joseph understood them, for he spoke unto them by an interpreter. And he turned from them and wept, and then turned to them again and communed with them, and took out Simeon from among them and bound him before their eyes, and commanded to fill their sacks with corn, and to put every mans money in his sack, and to give them victual to spend by the way. And so it was done to them. And they laddened their asses with the corn and departed there. And as one of them opened his sack, for to give his ass provender in the Inn, he spied his money in his sacks mouth. And he said unto his brethren: my money is restored me again, and is even in my sacks mouth. Then their hearts failed them, and were astonished and said one to another: how comes it that God deals thus with us. And they came unto Jacob their father unto the land of Canaan, and told him all that had happened them saying: The lord of the land spoke roughly to us, and took us for spies to search the country. And we said unto him: we mean truly and are no spies. We be twelve brethren sons of our father, one is away, and the youngest is now with our father in the land of Canaan. And the lord of the country said unto us: hereby shall I know if you mean truly: leave one of your brethren here with me, and take food necessary for your households and get you away, and bring your youngest brother unto me. And thereby shall I know that you are no spies, but mean truly: So will I deliver you your brother again, and you shall occupy in the land. And as they emptied their sacks, behold: every mans bundle of money was in his sack. And when both they and their father saw the bundles of money, they were afraid.

And Jacob their father said unto them: Me have you robbed of my children: Joseph is away, and Simeon is away, and you will take Ben Jamin away. All these things fall upon me. Ruben answered his father saying: Slay my two sons, if I bring him not to you again. Deliver him therefore to my hand, and I will bring him to you again: And he said: my son shall not go down with you. For his brother is dead, and

he is left alone. Moreover some misfortune might happen upon him by the way which you go. And so should you bring my gray head with sorrow unto the grave.

The 43rd Chapter

And the dearth waxed sore in the land. And when they had eaten up that corn which they brought out of the land of Egypt, their father said unto them: go again and buy us a little food. Then said Juda unto him: the man did testify unto us saying: look that you see not my face except your brother be with you. Therefore if you will send our brother with us, we will go and buy the food. But if you will not send him, we will not go: for the man said unto us: look that you see not my face, except your brother be with you. And Israel said: wherefore dealt you so cruelly with me, as to tell the man that you had yet another brother? And they said: The man asked us of our kindred saying: is your father yet alive? have you not another brother? And we told him according to these words. How could we know that he would bid us bring our brother down with us? Then said Juda unto Israel his father: Send the lad with me, and we will rise and go, that we may live and not die: both we, you and also our children. I will be surety for him, and of my hands require him. If I bring him not to you and set him before your eyes, then let me bear the blame for ever. For except we had made this tarrying: by this we had been there twice and come again.

Then their father Israel said unto them: if it must needs be so now: then do thus, take of the best fruits of the land in your vessels, and bring the man a present, a courtesy balm, and a courtesy of honey, spices and myrrh, dates and almonds. And take as much money more with you. And the money that was brought again in your sacks, take it again with you, peradventure it was some oversight.

Take also your brother with you, and arise and go again to the man. And God almighty give you mercy in the sight of the man and send you your other brother and also Ben Jamin, and I will be as a man robbed of his children.

Thus took they the present and twice so much more money with them, and Ben Jamin. And rose up, went down to Egypt, and presented themselves to Joseph. When Joseph saw Ben Jamin with them, he said to the ruler of his house: bring these men home, and slay and make ready: for they shall dine with me at noon. And the man did as Joseph bade, and brought them in to Josephs house.

When they were brought to Josephs house, they were afraid and said: because of the money that came in our sacks mouths at the first time, are we brought, to pick a quarrel with us and to lay some thing to our charge to bring us in bondage and our asses also. Therefore came they to the man that was the ruler over Josephs house, and communed with him at the door and said:

Sir, we came hither at the first time to buy food, and as we came to an inn and opened our sacks: behold, every mans money was in his sack with full weight: But

we have brought it again with us, and other money have we brought also in our hands, to buy food, but we cannot tell who put our money in our sacks. And he said: be of good cheer, fear not: Your God and the God of your fathers has put you that treasure in your sacks, for I had your money. And he brought Simeon out to them and led them into Josephs house, and gave them water to wash their feet, and gave their asses provender: And they made ready their present against Joseph came at noon, for they heard say that they should dine there. When Joseph came home, they brought the present into the house to him, which they had in their hands, and fell hat on the ground before him. And he welcomed them courteously saying: is your father that old man which you told me of, in good health? and is he yet alive? they answered: your servant our father is in good health, and is yet alive. And they bowed themselves and fell to the ground.

And he lifted up his eyes and beheld his brother Ben Jamin his mothers son, and said: is this your youngest brother of whom you said unto me? And said: God be merciful unto you my son. And Joseph made haste (for his heart did melt upon his brother) and sought where to weep, and entered into his chamber, for to weep there. And he washed his face and came out and refrained himself, and bade set bread on the table.

And they prepared for him by himself, and for them by themselves, and for the Egyptians which ate with him by themselves, because the Egyptians may not eat bread with the Hebrews, for that is an abomination unto the Egyptians. And they sat before him: the eldest according unto his age, and the youngest according unto his youth. And the men marveled among themselves. And they brought rewards unto them from before him: but Ben Jamins part was five times so much as any of theirs. And they ate and they drank, and were drunk with him.

The 44th Chapter

And he commanded the ruler of his house saying: fill the mens sacks with food, as much as they can carry, and put every mans money in his bag mouth, and put my silver cup in the sacks mouth of the youngest and his corn money also. And he did as Joseph had said. And in the morning as soon as it was light, the men were let go with their asses. And when they were out of the city and not yet far away, Joseph said unto the ruler of his house: up and follow after the men and overtake them, and say unto them: wherefore have you rewarded evil for good? is that not the cup of which my lord drinks, and does he not prophesy therein? you have evil done that you have done.

And he overtook them and said the same words unto them. And they answered him: wherefore says my lord such words? God forbid that your servants should do so. Behold, the money which we found in our sacks mouths, we brought again unto you, out of the land of Canaan: how then should we steal out of my lords house, either silver or gold? with whosoever of your servants it be found let him

die, and let us also be my lords bondmen. And he said: Now therefore according unto your words, he with whom it is found, shall be my servant: but ye, shall be harmless.

And at once every man took down his sack to the ground, and every man opened his sack. And he searched, and began at the eldest and left at the youngest. And the cup was found in Ben Jamins sack. Then they rent their clothes, and laded every man his ass and went again unto the city. And Juda and his brethren came to Josephs house, for he was yet there, and they fell before him on the ground. And Joseph said unto them: what deed is this which you have done? knew you not that such a man as I can prophesy?

Then said Juda: what shall we say unto my lord, what shall we speak or what excuse can we make? God has found out the wickedness of your servants. Behold, both we and he with whom the cup is found, are your servants. And he answered: God forbid that I should do so, the man with whom the cup is found, he shall be my servant: but go you in peace unto your father. Then Juda went unto him and said: oh my lord, let your servant speak a word in my lords ear, and be not wroth with your servant: for you are even as Pharaos. My lord asked his servant saying: have you a father or a brother? And we answered my lord, we have a father that is old, and a young lad which he begat in his age: and the brother of the said lad is dead, and he is all that is left of that mother. And his father loves him. Then said my lord unto his servants bring him unto me, that I may set mine eyes upon him. And we answered my lord, that the lad could not go from his father, for if he should leave his father, he were but a dead man. Then said you unto your servants: except your youngest brother come with you, look that you see my face no more.

And when we came unto your servant our father, we showed him what my lord had said. And when our father said unto us, go again and buy us a little food: we said, that we could not go. Nevertheless if our youngest brother go with us then will we go, for we may not see the mans face, except our youngest brother be with us. Then said your servant our father unto us. you know that my wife bare me two sons. And the one went out from me and it is said of a surety that he is torn in pieces of wild beasts, and I saw him not since. If you shall take this also away from me and some misfortune happen upon him, then shall you bring my gray head with sorrow unto the grave.

Now therefore when I come to your servant my father, if the lad be not with me: seeing that his life hangeth by the lads life, then as soon as he sees that the lad is not come, he will die. So shall we your servants bring the gray head of your servant our father with sorrow unto the grave. For I your servant became surety for the lad unto my father and said: if I bring him not unto you again. I will bear the blame all my life long. Now therefore let me your servant bide here for the lad, and be my

lords bondman: and let the lad go home with his brethren. For how can I go unto my father, and the lad not with me: least I should see the wretchedness that shall come on my father.

The 45th Chapter

And Joseph could no longer refrain before all them that stood about him, but commanded that they should go all out from him, and that there should be no man with him, while he uttered himself unto his brethren. And he wept aloud, so that the Egyptians and the house of Pharaoh heard it. And he said unto his brethren: I am Joseph, does my father yet live? But his brethren could not answer him, for they were abashed at his presence. And Joseph said unto his brethren: come near to me, and they came near. And he said: I am Joseph your brother whom you sold into Egypt. And now be not grieved therewith, neither let it seem a cruel thing in your eyes, that you sold me here. For God did send me before you to save life. For this is the second year of dearth in the land, and five more are behind in which there shall neither be earing nor harvest.

Wherefore God sent me before you to make provision, that you might continue in the earth and to save your lives by a great deliverance. So now it was not you that sent me here, but God: and he has made me father unto Pharaoh and lord over all his house, and ruler in all the land of Egypt. Haste you and go to my father and tell him, this says your son Joseph: God has made me lord over all Egypt. Come down unto me and tarry not. And you shall dwell in the land of Goshen and be by me: both you and your children, and your children's children: and your sheep, and beasts and all that you have. There will I make provision for you: for there remain yet five years of dearth, lest you and your household and all that you have perish.

Behold, your eyes do see, and the eyes also of my brother Benjamin, that I speak to you by mouth. Therefore tell my father of all my honor which I have in Egypt and of all that you have seen, and make haste and bring my father here. And he fell on his brother Benjamin's neck and wept, and Benjamin wept on his neck. Moreover he kissed all his brethren and wept upon them. And after that, his brethren talked with him. And when the tidings were come unto Pharaoh's house that Joseph's brethren were come, it pleased Pharaoh well and all his servants.

And Pharaoh spoke unto Joseph: say unto your brethren, this do ye: load your beasts and get you from this place, And when you be come unto the land of Canaan, take your father and your households and come unto me, and I will give you the best of the land of Egypt, and you shall eat the fat of the land. And commanded also. This do ye: take chariots with you out of the land of Egypt, for your children and for your wives: and bring your father and come. Also, regard not your stuff, for the goods of all the land of Egypt shall be yours.

And the children of Israel did even so, And Joseph gave them chariots at the commandment of Pharaoh, and gave them victual also to spend by the way. And he

gave unto each of them change of raiment: but unto Ben Jamin he gave three hundred pieces of silver and five changes of raiment. And unto his father he sent after the same manner: ten asses laden with goods out of Egypt, and ten she asses laden with corn, bread and meat: to serve his father by the way. So sent he his brethren away, and they departed. And he said unto them: see that you fall not out by the way.

And they departed from Egypt and came into the land of Canaan unto Jacob their father, and told him saying. Joseph is yet alive and is governor over all the land of Egypt. And Jacobs heart wavered, for he believed them not. And they told him all the words of Joseph which he had said unto them. But when he saw the chariots which Joseph had sent to carry him, then his spirits revived. And Israel said: I have enough, if Joseph my son be yet alive: I will go and see him, before that I die.

The 46th Chapter

Israel took his journey with all that he had, and came unto Berseba and offered offerings unto the God of his father Isaac. And God said unto Israel in a vision by night, and called unto him: Jacob, Jacob. And he answered: here am I. And he said: I am that mighty God of your father, fear not to go down into Egypt. For I will make of you there a great people. I will go down with you into Egypt, and I will also bring you up again, and Joseph shall put his hand upon your eyes. And Jacob rose up from Berseba. And the sons of Israel carried Jacob their father, and their children and their wives in the chariots which Pharaoh had sent to carry him. And they took their cattle and the goods which they had gotten in the land of Canaan, and came into Egypt: both Jacob and all his seed with him, his sons and his sons sons with him: his daughters and his sons daughters and all his seed brought he with him into Egypt.

These are the names of the children of Israel which came into Egypt, both Jacob and his sons: Ruben Jacobs first son. The children of Ruben: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron and Charmi. The children of Simeon: Jemuel, Jami, Ohad, Jachin, Zohar and Saul the son of a Cananitish woman. The children of Levi: Gerson, Kahas and Merari. The children of Juda: Er, Onan, Sela, Pharez and Zerah, but Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan. The children of Pharez, Hezron, and Hamul. The children of Isachar: Tola, Phua, Job and Semson. The children of Zabulon: Sered, Elon and Jaheleel. These be the children of Lea which she bare unto Jacob in Mesopotamia with his daughter Dina. All these souls of his sons and daughters make thirty and three.

The children of Gad: Ziphion, Haggi, Suni, Ezbon, Eri, Arodi and Areli. The children of Asser: Jemna, Jesua, Jesui, Bria and Serah their sister. And the children of Bria were Heber and Malchiel. These are the children of Silpha whom Laban gave to Lea his daughter. And these she bare unto Jacob in number sixteen souls.

The children of Rahel Jacobs wife: Joseph and Ben Jamin. And unto Joseph in the land of Egypt were born: Manasses and Ephraim which Asnath the daughter of Putiphar priest of On bare unto him. The children of Ben Jamin: Bela, Becher, Asbel, Gera, Naeman, Ehi, Ros, Mupim, Hupim and Ard. These are the children of Rahel which were born unto Jacob: fourteen souls altogether. The children of Dan: Husim. The children Nepthali: Jahezeel, Guni, Jezer and Sillem. These are the sons of Bilha which Laban gave unto Rahel his daughter, and she bare these unto Jacob, altogether seven souls. All the souls that came with Jacob into Egypt which came out of his loins (besides his sons wives) were all together sixty and six souls. And the sons of Joseph, which were born him in Egypt were: two souls. So that all the souls of the house of Jacob which came into Egypt are seventy.

And he sent Juda before him unto Joseph that the way might be showed him unto Gosan, and they came into the land of Gosan. And Joseph made ready his chariot and went to meet Israel his father unto Gosan, and presented himself unto him, and fell on his neck and wept upon his neck a good while. And Israel said unto Joseph: Now I am content to die, insomuch I have seen you, that you are yet alive.

And Joseph said unto his brethren and unto his fathers house: I will go and show Pharaos and tell him: that my brethren and my fathers house which were in the land of Canaan are come unto me, and how they are shepherds (for they were men of cattle) and they have brought their sheep and their oxen and all that they have with them. If Pharaoh call you and ask you what your occupation is, say: your servants have been occupied about cattle, from our childhood unto this time: both we and our fathers, that you may dwell in the land of Gosan. For the Egyptians abhor all shepherds.

The 47th Chapter

And Joseph went and told Pharaoh and said: my father and my brethren their sheep and their beasts and all that they have, are come out of the land of Canaan and are in the land of Gosan. And Joseph took a part of his brethren: even five of them, and presented them unto Pharaoh. And Pharaoh said unto his brethren: what is your occupation? And they said unto Pharaoh: shepherds are your servants, both we and also our fathers. They said moreover unto Pharaoh: for to sojourn in the land are we come, for your servants have no pasture for their sheep so sore is the famishment in the land of Canaan. Now therefore let your servants dwell in the land of Gosan.

And Pharaoh said unto Joseph: your father and your brethren are come unto you. The land of Egypt is open before you: In the best place of the land make both your father and your brethren dwell: And even in the land of Gosan let them dwell. Moreover if you know any men of activity among them, make them rulers over my cattle. And Joseph brought in Jacob his father and set him before Pharaoh. And Jacob blessed Pharaoh. And Pharaoh asked Jacob, how old are you? And Jacob said

unto Pharaos: the days of my pilgrimage are an hundred and thirty years. Few and evil have the days of my life been, and have not attained unto the years of the life of my fathers in the days of their pilgrimages. And Jacob blessed Pharaos and went out from him. And Joseph prepared dwellings for his father and his brethren, and gave them possessions in the land of Egypt, in the best of the land: even in the land of Rameses, as Pharaos commanded. And Joseph made provision for his father, his brethren and all his fathers household, as young children are fed with bread.

There was no bread in all the land, for the dearth was exceeding sore: so that the land of Egypt and the land of Canaan, were famished by the reason of the dearth. And Joseph brought together all the money that was found in the land of Egypt and of Canaan, for the corn which they bought: and he laid up the money in Pharaos house. When money failed in the land of Egypt and of Canaan, all the Egyptians came unto Joseph and said: give us sustenance: wherefore allow you us to die before you: for our money is spent. Then said Joseph: bring your cattle, and I will give you for your cattle, if you be without money. And they brought their cattle unto Joseph. And he gave them bread for horses and sheep, and oxen and asses: so he fed them with bread for all their cattle that year.

When that year was ended, they came unto him the next year and said unto him: we will not hide it from my lord, how that we have neither money nor cattle for my lord: there is no more left for my lord, but even our bodies and our lands. Wherefore let you us die before your eyes, and the land to go to nought? buy us and our lands for bread: and let both us and our lands be bond to Pharaos. Give us seed, that we may live and not die, and that the land go not to waste.

And Joseph bought all the land of Egypt for Pharaos. For the Egyptians sold every man his land because the dearth was sore upon them: and so the land became Pharaos. And he appointed the people unto the cities, from one side of Egypt unto the other: only the land of the Priests bought he not. For there was an ordinance made by Pharaos for the priests, that they should eat that which was appointed unto them: which Pharaos had given them wherefore they sold not their lands.

Then Joseph said unto the folk: behold I have bought you this day and your lands for Pharaos. Take there seed and go sow the land. And of the increase, you shall give the fifth part unto Pharaos, and four parts shall be your own, for seed to sow the field: and for you, and them of your households, and for your children, to eat. And they answered: You have saved our lives. Let us find grace in the sight of my lord, and let us be Pharaos servants. And Joseph made it a law over the land of Egypt unto this day: that men must give Pharaos the fifth part, except the land of the priests only, which was not bond unto pharaos.

And Israel dwelt in Egypt: even in the country of Gosan. And they had their possessions therein, and they grew and multiplied exceedingly. Moreover Jacob

lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years, so that the whole age of Jacob was an hundred and forty seven years.

When the time drew nigh, that Israel must die: he sent for his son Joseph and said unto him: If I have found grace in your sight, put your hand under my thigh and deal mercifully and truly with me, that you bury me not in Egypt: but let me lie by my fathers, and carry me out of Egypt, and bury me in their burial. And he answered: I will do as you have said. And he said: swear unto me. And he sware unto him. And then Israel bowed him unto the beds head.

God's Truth

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The First Book of Moses

also called Genesis from the Latin

(Part Eight)

The 48th Chapter

After these deeds, tidings were brought unto Joseph, that his father was sick. And he took with him his two sons, Manasse and Ephraim. Then was it said unto Jacob: behold, your son Joseph comes unto you. And Israel took his strength unto him, and sat up on the bed, and said unto Joseph: God almighty appeared unto me at Lus in the land of Canaan, and blessed me, and said unto me: behold, I will make you grow and will multiply you, and will make a great number of people of you, and will give this land unto you and unto your seed after you unto an everlasting possession. Now therefore your two sons Manasse and Ephraim which were born unto you before I came to you, into Egypt, shall be mine: even as Ruben and Simeon shall they be unto me. And the children which you get after them, shall be your own: but shall be called with the names of their brethren in their inheritances. And after I came from Mesopotamia, Rahel died upon my hand in the land of Canaan, by the way: when I had but a fields breadth to go unto Ephrat. And I buried her there in the way to Ephrat which is now called Bethlehem.

And Israel beheld Josephs sons and said: what are these? And Joseph said unto his father: they are my sons, which God has given me here. And he said: bring them to me, and let me bless them. And the eyes of Israel were dim for age, so that he could not see. And he brought them to him, and he kissed them and embraced them. And Israel said unto Joseph: I had not thought to have seen your

face, and yet lo, God has showed it me and also your seed. And Joseph took them away from his lap, and they fell on the ground before him.

Then took Joseph them both: Ephraim in his right hand toward Israels left hand and Manasse in his left hand, toward Israels right hand, and brought them unto him. And Israel stretched out his right hand and laid it upon Ephraims head which was the younger, and his left hand upon Manasses head, crossing his hands, for Manasse was the elder. And he blessed Joseph saying: God before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac did walk, and the God which has fed me all my life long unto this day, And the angel which has delivered me from all evil, bless these lads: that they may be called after my name, and after my father Abraham and Isaac, and that they may grow and multiply upon the earth.

When Joseph saw that his father laid his right hand upon the head of Ephraim, it displeased him. And he lifted up his fathers hand, to have removed it from Ephraims head unto Manasses head, and said unto his father: Not so my father, for this is the eldest. Put your right hand upon his head. And his father would not, but said: I know it well my son, I know it well. He shall be also a people and shall be great. But of a truth his younger brother shall be greater than he, and his seed shall be full of people. And he blessed them saying: At the example of these, the Israelites shall bless and say: God make you as Ephraim and as Manasse. Thus set he Ephraim before Manasse.

And Israel said unto Joseph: behold, I die. And God shall be with you and bring you again unto the land of your fathers. Moreover I give unto you, a portion of land above your brethren which I got out of the hands of the Amorites with my sword and with my bow.

The 49th Chapter

And Jacob called for his sons and said: come together, that I may tell you what shall happen you in the last days. Gather you together and hear you sons of Jacob, and hearken unto Israel your father.

Ruben, you are mine eldest son, my might and the beginning of my strength, chief in receiving and chief in power. As unstable as water was you: you shall therefore not be the chiefest, for you went up upon your fathers bed, and then defiled you my couch with going up.

The brethren Simeon and Levi, wicked instruments are their weapons. Into their secrets come not my soul, and unto their congregation be my honor not coupled: for in their wrath they slew a man, and in their self will they *houghed an ox. Cursed be their wrath for it was strong, and their fierceness for it was cruel. I will therefore divide them in Jacob, and scatter them in Israel. *houghed; marginal note: to cut the sinews of the leg so that it could not walk. (hamstring)

Juda, your brethren shall praise you, and your hand shall be in the neck of your enemies, and your fathers children shall stoop unto you. Juda is a lions whelp.

From spoil my son you are come on high: he laid him down and couched himself as a lion, and as a lioness. Who dare stir him up? The scepter shall not depart from Juda, nor a ruler from between his legs, until Silo come, unto whom the people shall hearken. He shall bind his foal unto the vine, and his asses colt unto the vine branch, and shall wash his garment in wine and his mantle in the blood of grapes: his eyes are *roudier than wine, and his teeth whiter then milk. *roudier (unknown of sources) maybe rowdier: wilder or red from rouge.

Zabulon shall dwell in the haven of the sea and in the port of ships, and shall reach unto Sidon.

Isachar is a strong ass, he couched him down between two borders, and saw that rest was good and the land that it was pleasant, and bowed his shoulder to bear, and became a servant unto tribute. Dan shall judge his people, as one of the tribes of Israel. Dan shall be a serpent in the way, and an adder in the path, and bite the horse heels, so that his rider shall fall backward. After your saving look I, Lord.

Gad, men of war shall invade him. And he shall turn them to flight.

Of Asser comes fat bread, and he shall give pleasures for a king.

Nephtalim is a swift hind, and gives goodly words. That flourishing child Joseph, that flourishing child and goodly unto the eye: the daughters ran upon the wall. The shooters have envied him and chide with him and hated him, and yet his bow bode fast, and his arms and his hands were strong, by the hands of the mighty God of Jacob: out of him shall come an herdsman, a stone in Israel. your father s God shall help you, and the almighty shall bless you with blessings from heaven above, and with blessings of the water that lies under, and with blessings of the breasts and of the womb. The blessings of your father were strong: even as the blessings of my elders, after the desire of the highest in the world, and these blessings shall fall on the head of Joseph, and on the top of the head of him that was separated from his brethren.

Ben Jamin is a ravishing wolf. In the morning he shall devour his prey, and at night he shall divide his spoil.

All these are the twelve tribes of Israel, and this is that which their father spoke unto them when he blessed them, every man with a several blessing. And he charged them and said unto them. I shall be put unto my people: see that you bury me with my fathers, in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Hethite, in the double cave that is in the field before Mare in the land of Canaan. Which field Abraham bought of Ephron the Hethite for a possession to bury in. There they buried Abraham and Sara his wife, there they buried Isaac and Rebecca his wife. And there I buried Lea: which field and the cave that is therein, was bought of the children of Heth.

When Jacob had commanded all that he would unto his sons, he plucked up his

feet upon the bed and died, and was put unto his people, And Joseph fell upon his fathers face, and wept upon him, and kissed him.

The 50th Chapter

And Joseph commanded his servants that were Physicians, to embalm his father, and the Physicians embalmed Israel forty days long, for so long does the embalming last, and the Egyptians bewept him seventy days.

And when the days of weeping were ended, Joseph spoke unto the house of Pharaos saying: If I have found favour in your eyes, speak unto Pharaoh and tell him, how that my father made me swear and said: lo, I die, see that you bury me in my grave which I have made me in the land of Canaan. Now therefore let me go and bury my father, and then will I come again. And Pharaoh said, go and bury your father, according as he made you swear.

And Joseph went up to bury his father, and with him went all the servants of Pharaoh that were the elders of his house, and all the elders of Egypt, and all the house of Joseph and his brethren and his fathers house: only their children and their sheep and their cattle left they behind them in the land of Goshen. And there went with him also Chariots and horsemen: so that they were an exceeding great company.

And when they came to the field of Atad beyond Jordan, there they made great and exceeding sore lamentation. And he mourned for his father seven days. When the inhabitants of the land the Canaanites saw the mourning in the field of Atad, they said: this is a great mourning which the Egyptians make. Wherefore the name of the place is called Abelmizraim, which place lies beyond Jordan. And his sons did unto him according as he had commanded them.

And his sons carried him into the land of Canaan and buried him in the double cave which Abraham had bought with the field to be a place to bury in, of Ephron the Hethite before Mamre. And Joseph returned to Egypt again and his brethren, and all that went up with him to bury his father, as soon as he had buried him.

When Josephs brethren saw that their father was dead, they said: Joseph might fortune to hate us and reward us again all the evil which we did unto him. They did therefore a commandment unto Joseph saying: your father charged before his death saying: This wise say unto Joseph, forgive I pray you the trespass of your brethren and their sin, for they rewarded you evil. Now therefore we pray you, forgive the trespass of the servants of your fathers God. And Joseph wept when they spoke unto him.

And his brethren came and fell before him and said: behold we be your servants. And Joseph said unto them: fear not, for am not I under God? you thought evil unto me: but God turned it unto good to bring to pass, as it is this day, even to save much people alive. Fear not therefore, for I will care for you and for your children, and he spoke kindly unto them.

Joseph dwelt in Egypt and his fathers house also, and lived an hundred and ten years. And Joseph saw Ephraims children, even unto the third generation. And unto Machir the son of Manasse were children born, and sat on Josephs knees.

And Joseph said unto his brethren: I die. And God will surely visit you and bring you out of this land, unto the land which he sware unto Abraham, Isaac and Jacob. And Joseph took an oath of the children of Israel and said: God will not fail but visit you: see therefore that you carry my bones from this place . And so Joseph died, when he was an hundred and ten years old. And they embalmed him and put him in a chest in Egypt.

The end of the first book